The $1k Club

Your Guide to Making $1,000 on social media in 30 days

Scrolly

Contents

Meet the five example businesses 3

GETTING STARTED

1 Why $1,000, and why Instagram 4

2 Your offer and buying path 6

3 Your free toolkit 9

INSTAGRAM BASICS

4 Your profile and bio 12

5 The four kinds of posts 15

YOUR PLAN

6 Your $1K plan 17

7 Your 30-day posting schedule 22

WHAT TO POST

8 Captions, on-screen text, and first comments 25

9 Reels 36

Series Reels 42

10 Carousels 48

11 Stories 55

REVIEW AND KEEP GOING

12 Review what's working 60

13 Your 30 days, start to finish 64

Want Scrolly to run this with you? 66

REFERENCE

Appendix: 20 Reel examples 67

Sources 78

The companion guide, **Social Media Quality Tips**, covers filming, sound, editing, and upload settings. This book points to it where it helps.

Meet the five example businesses

These five made-up businesses appear all through the book, so you can see how the same plan works at different prices. Their posts, numbers, and situations are illustrations, never real results.

Business	What they sell	Who buys	Price
Fix-It Frank	Home repairs in Austin: fences, decks, drywall	Homeowners with a repair they keep putting off	$250 average job
Golden Hour Studio	Relaxed 45-minute family photo sessions in Denver	Parents who want photos before the holidays	$350 session
Sunday Supply Co.	Soft tees and canvas totes, sold on Etsy	People who like comfortable, simple weekend clothes	$28 tee, $48 tee and tote bundle
Paper & Pixel	Editable party-invitation kits you finish in Canva	Parents planning a child's birthday party	$25 kit, instant download
Ops Clarity	Operations audits for small creative agencies	Agency owners whose projects keep running late	$500 audit

Where each one sends buyers

Business	The bio link goes to
Fix-It Frank	A quote form. Frank replies the same day with a price and a date.
Golden Hour Studio	A booking page that shows real open dates.
Sunday Supply Co.	The Etsy listing for the bundle.
Paper & Pixel	The kit's checkout page.
Ops Clarity	A booking page for a free 20-minute call, then the audit.

Three of them sell services, so a visit leads to a quote, a booking, or a call before money changes hands. Two sell products people can buy on the spot. You'll see both kinds of path in every chapter.

CHAPTER 1

Why $1,000, and why Instagram

Your first $1,000 is a goal you can work toward in 30 days, and reaching it teaches you how your business actually sells.

Why start with $1,000

It proves people will pay.

The first sales are the hardest. Reaching $1,000 shows you, in real orders and bookings, that people want what you make.

It gives you real numbers.

Once you've sold, you know how many people saw your posts, visited your page, and bought. Your next goal gets planned with your own data.

It changes your month.

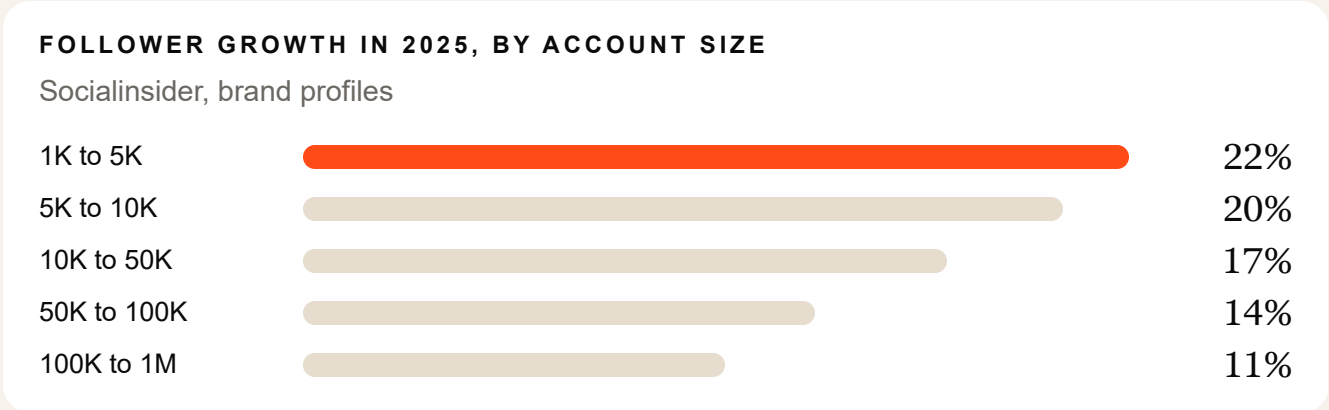
An extra $1,000 can cover a car payment, a month of groceries, or the next batch of stock.

It fits a small account.

Depending on your price, $1,000 is often somewhere between a handful of bookings and a few dozen orders. That's a workable number of buyers to find in 30 days.

Small accounts grow faster

In Socialinsider's study of 447,613 brand profiles, the smallest accounts grew fastest in 2025.[1] A small account has room to move quickly.



Why Instagram

You'll share the same videos to several apps (Chapter 3), and Instagram is home base. It gives a small business everything the buying path needs in one place: a link in your bio, link stickers in Stories for every account, direct messages, and Trial Reels for reaching new people.

App	What Metricool's 2026 study of 6.2 million short videos found
TikTok	The most views: up to 42% more than Instagram Reels
Instagram	The most shares at every account size, and the most comments for most account sizes
YouTube Shorts	About a sixth of TikTok's views

Shares and comments are conversations, and conversations are where questions, quotes, and bookings start.[2] TikTok's extra views still help you, so this plan sends every video there too.

Two Instagram features this plan uses every week

1. Trial Reels: reach people who don't follow you yet

A Trial Reel is shown to people who don't follow you. It stays off your profile and out of your followers' feeds unless you share it with everyone. A follower can still come across one, for example if someone sends it to them. That makes Trial Reels a low-pressure way to test three versions of each Reel, then share the winner with everyone.

You can use them on a public professional account with at least 200 followers.[3] Until then, regular Reels do the same job. Chapter 9 shows how to use them.

2. Repost what worked

When a Reel performs well, you can post it again with a small edit, like a new first line or a tighter cut. Twice a week, your best feed Reel gets a second run with people who missed it. Chapter 9 explains how.

CHAPTER 2

Your offer and buying path

Before you post, make sure a stranger can understand what you sell and buy it from their phone. This chapter takes about an hour.

One offer, one price

For these 30 days, lead with one thing. You can still sell everything else, and one clear offer makes every post easier to write. Finish this sentence:

> I sell _what_ to _who_ for _$ price_. To get it, they _next step_.

Business	Offer sentence
Fix-It Frank	I fix fences, decks, and drywall for Austin homeowners, about $250 a job. To get a price, they send a photo through my quote form.
Golden Hour Studio	I photograph Denver families in relaxed 45-minute sessions for $350. To book, they pick a date on my booking page.
Sunday Supply Co.	I sell a soft tee and canvas tote bundle for $48. To buy, they order the bundle on Etsy.
Paper & Pixel	I sell editable birthday-invitation kits for $25. To buy, they check out and download the kit instantly.
Ops Clarity	I audit how work moves through small creative agencies for $500. To start, they book a free 20-minute call.

One buyer, one moment

You don't need a detailed customer profile. Four plain answers will shape every hook and caption you write:

1. Who buys, in plain words?

"Homeowners with a repair they keep putting off."

2. What moment sends them looking?

A gate that won't latch. Holiday cards are due. The party is in two weeks.

3. What almost stops them?

The price, not knowing if you're any good, timing, or "will this work for me?"

4. What words do they use?

Copy them from real messages, reviews, and questions: "My kids won't sit still," "Is it worth fixing?"

How Golden Hour turns the answers into posts

Illustrative example

Answer	Becomes	Example
The moment	A Reel hook	"Holiday cards in three weeks? Here's what a 45-minute session looks like."
What almost stops them	A carousel or Story	"My kids won't sit still." Then show how the session works with that.
Their words	On-screen text and captions	"Relaxed," "not stiff," "the kids had fun"

A buying path that works on a phone

Your bio link should open the page where people pay, book, or ask for a quote. Then check it the way a customer would.

THE PHONE CHECK

1. Open your profile on your phone and tap your link.
2. Try to buy, book, or request a quote.
3. Note every moment you had to scroll, zoom, or guess.
4. Fix the first problem you found.

A CLEAR PAGE HAS

- The price, or "from $___"
- What happens next: "Quote by text within 24 hours," "Instant download," "Ships in 3 days"
- Text you can read without zooming
- Only the questions you truly need

No reviews yet? Show the work

New businesses can build trust by demonstrating what they do. Each of these works with no customers at all:

Show	Example
The process	Frank films how he checks whether a post is rotten below the ground.
The product in use	Sunday Supply wears the tee on a coffee run and shows the fabric up close.
How you decide	Ops Clarity explains the three questions she asks in every audit.
Your own before and after	Paper & Pixel edits a blank kit into a finished invitation on screen.
Answers to real questions	Golden Hour answers "What should we wear?" with a short list and photos.

Use only real reviews, real results, and real availability. When you get your first happy customer, ask if you can share their words.

Replying to interested people

When someone comments or messages with a question, a short, friendly reply is part of selling. Answer the question, give the detail they need, share the link or next step, and follow up once if they go quiet.

A QUOTE SERVICE

"How much to fix a leaning fence?"

"Good question. It depends on how many posts have moved. Most single-post repairs take an afternoon. If you send a photo through the quote form in my bio, I'll reply today with a price and a date."

A PRODUCT

"Does the tee run big?"

"It's a relaxed fit. Most people take their usual size, and size down for a closer fit. The size chart is on the listing, and the bundle link is in my bio."

YOUR TURN

Write your offer sentence and your four buyer answers, then do the phone check and fix the first problem you hit.

CHAPTER 3

Your free toolkit

Everything in this plan runs on free accounts. Set them up once, and every video you make can reach five apps.

Instagram

Your home base

Switch to a free professional account to get Insights and Trial Reels: **Profile** → **☰ menu** → **Account type and tools** → **Switch to professional account** . You'll choose one of two types:

Type	Best for	Good to know
Business	Shops, local businesses, and service providers, in Instagram's own guidance[4]	Product tags and shop features. Business accounts often see a smaller music library of commercially licensed songs.
Creator	People whose content is the product, like coaches, artists, and educators	A wider music library, and the same Insights and Trial Reels. Meta's music rules still apply to business promotion (Chapter 9).

Either works for this plan, and you can switch later. Then check these settings:

- **Account privacy: Public.** Professional accounts are always public.
- **Settings** → **Account Status** : nothing listed that limits your reach.
- **Allow public photos and videos to appear in search engine results: On,** so people can find your posts from Google.
- **Suggest your account to others: On,** so Instagram can recommend you on similar accounts.
- **Alt text:** when you post a photo, tap **Advanced settings** → **Write alt text** and describe it, so people using screen readers know what it shows.

Facebook

Automatic, once it's connected

1. Create a Facebook **Page** for your business if you don't have one: **Facebook** → **Menu** → **Pages** → **Create**. A name and category are enough.
2. Add Instagram and Facebook to the same Accounts Center. Then in Instagram: **☰ menu** → **Accounts Center** → **Sharing across profiles**. Choose Instagram as the source and your **Page** as the destination.
3. Under **Automatically share**, turn on **Your Instagram reels** and your posts.[5]
4. Turn on **Your Instagram story** too, so your Stories also appear as Facebook Stories.[6]
5. Check that your Facebook Reels audience is **Public**. It starts as public when your Instagram account is public.

Once a Page is linked to your professional account, Instagram shares through that Page. After your first post, open Facebook and check that it landed on your Page, with the audience you expected.

Pinterest

Automatic, once it's linked

Create a free Pinterest business account and claim your website. Then link Instagram: **Pinterest settings** → **Link to Pinterest** → **Instagram**, log in, and choose whether to import recent posts.[7] Each new Instagram post becomes a Pin, usually within 24 hours.

- Pins link to your **claimed website**, which may be your homepage.[8] Make sure it leads clearly to your offer.
- Music Pinterest isn't licensed to use is muted, so make sure the video works without its song.
- You can tell Pinterest to skip posts containing certain words, which is handy for posts you'd rather keep off Pinterest.

TikTok

Posted through Buffer

Create a free account with the same name as your Instagram. You'll queue videos to it in Buffer.

YouTube Shorts

Posted through Buffer

Create a free YouTube channel for your business. Vertical videos under 3 minutes post as Shorts.

Buffer: your free scheduler

Buffer's free plan connects **3 channels** and holds **10 scheduled posts on each**.[9] Connect TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram. Facebook and Pinterest already follow Instagram automatically.

How the queue works: a slot opens each time a post goes out. If you schedule one video a day, 10 slots cover 10 days. At three a day, they cover about three days, so you'd top up twice a week. Scheduling the first comment is a paid feature, so add first comments yourself after posting (Chapter 8).

One video, five places. Post on Instagram and it reaches Facebook and Pinterest automatically. Queue the same file in Buffer for TikTok and YouTube Shorts. Always upload the file you exported from your editor and saved to your camera roll. A video downloaded from TikTok carries its watermark, and Instagram recommends watermarked videos from other apps less often.[10]

> YOUR TURN
>
> Set up the accounts, connect Facebook (Reels, posts, and Stories) and Pinterest to Instagram, and connect TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram to Buffer. Post one test Reel and check that it reached your Facebook Page.

CHAPTER 4

Your profile and bio

Every post sends curious people to your profile. In a few seconds, it should tell them what you sell, who it's for, and where to buy.

BIG TIP

Put your checkout page in your bio link.

Link straight to the page where people pay, book, or ask for a quote: your product page, Etsy listing, booking calendar, or quote form. Each extra tap through a homepage or menu loses some buyers. If you sell a few things, use a free link page with your main offer as the first button.



Illustrative profile. Stock photos stand in for Frank's own.

Profile photo: your logo, or a clear photo of you or your product.

Name: your name plus what you do, like "Frank | Handyman in Austin." People can find you by searching the words in this field.

Bio: what you sell, who it's for, the price or "from $__," and what to do next.

Link: your checkout, booking, or quote page.

Highlights: save your best Stories as "How to buy," "Reviews," and "FAQ," so they stay on your profile after 24 hours.

Pinned posts: pin up to three posts to the top of your grid: one that explains your offer, one that shows your work, and one that answers your most common question.

Bio formula

What you sell, for whom, and where. Price or "from $___." What to do next ↓

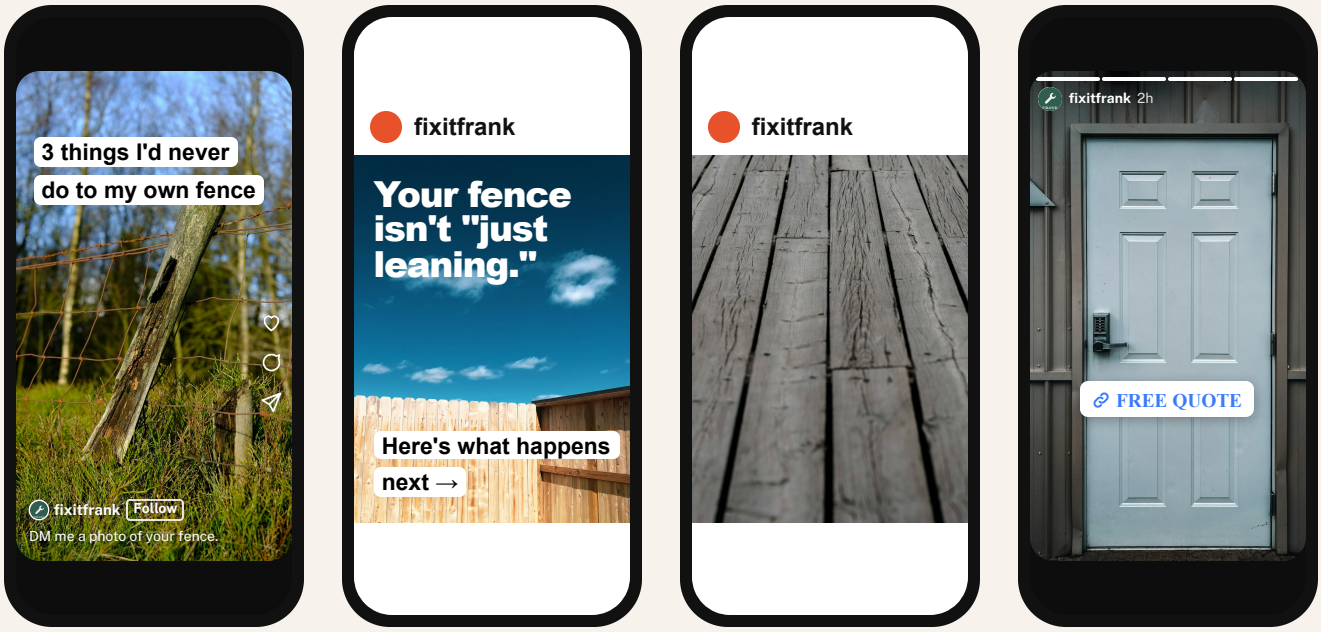
Business	Bio
Fix-It Frank	Home repairs in Austin: decks, fences, drywall. Free quotes, same-day reply ↓
Golden Hour Studio	Relaxed family photos in Denver. 45-minute sessions from $350. Pick your date ↓
Sunday Supply Co.	Soft tees and totes for slow weekends. Tee and tote bundle $48 ↓
Paper & Pixel	Editable party invitations you finish in Canva in 10 minutes. $25 kits, instant download ↓
Ops Clarity	Operations audits for small creative agencies. $500. Book a free 20-minute call ↓

> **YOUR TURN**
>
> Update your name field, bio, and link. Then open your profile on your phone and tap the link as if you were a customer.

CHAPTER 5

The four kinds of posts

Instagram has four main ways to post. Each one does a different job, so your plan uses all four.



Reels | Carousels | Single images | Stories

Post type	Main job	Who mostly sees it	Also appears on
Reels	Reach new people	Followers and non-followers	Facebook and Pinterest automatically; TikTok and YouTube Shorts through Buffer
Carousels	Teach, build trust, answer doubts	Followers and non-followers	Facebook and Pinterest automatically
Single images	A quick update	Followers, and sometimes non-followers	Facebook and Pinterest automatically
Stories	Help warm followers ask and buy	Mostly followers	Facebook Stories, if you turned it on

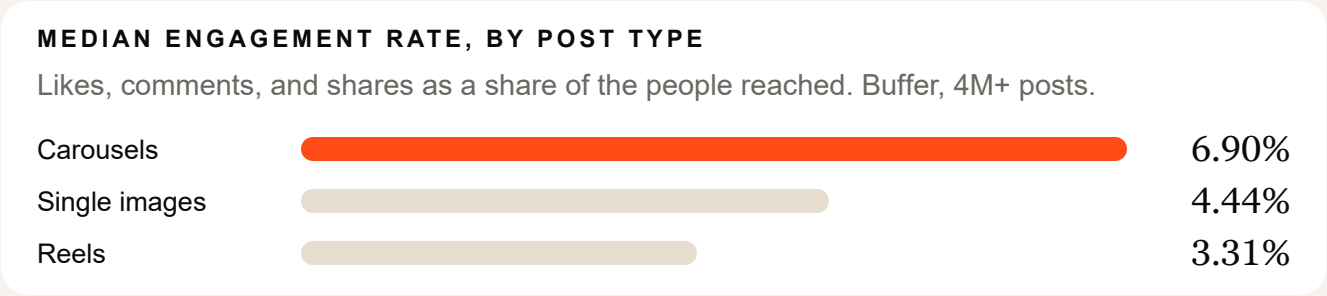
Reels reach the most people

Reels are short videos, and they're how most new people will find you. In Buffer's analysis of more than 4 million posts, Reels reached 36% more people than carousels and 125%

more than single images.[11] Most of your time in this plan goes into Reels (Chapter 9).

Carousels earn the most engagement

A carousel is a post of up to 20 photos or slides that people swipe through. In the same Buffer data, carousels had the highest median engagement rate: about twice that of Reels.[11]



Two habits help carousels travel further:

Add music before you share

Carousels with music may also be shown in the Reels tab, where people who don't follow you browse.[12] Music can be added to photo carousels, not carousels that include videos.[13]

Make slides 1 and 2 both strong

If someone scrolls past a carousel, Instagram may show it to them again starting on slide 2.[12] Each of the first two slides should make sense alone.

Single images: often better as a carousel

A single photo is the quickest post to make, and a carousel usually does more with it. When you have one good photo, add two or three related ones and post a carousel. You can even use the same photo as the background of every slide, with a different line of text on each.

Stories: for people who already follow you

Stories disappear after 24 hours unless you save them to a Highlight, and they're seen mostly by your followers. They're the place to answer questions, show what's happening this week, and invite warm followers to buy (Chapter 11).

CHAPTER 6

Your $1K plan

Your plan starts with the sales you need. From there, you can work out how many people need to visit your page, and roughly how many Instagram views bring those visits.

The words we'll use

Term	Meaning in this book
Revenue	Money customers paid you, before your costs. It isn't profit: product costs, platform fees, and your time still come out of it.
Average order value	The average amount of one sale, booking, or job.
Sales	Paid orders, bookings, or jobs.
Website visitors	Visits to your buying page from Instagram. In Instagram, the closest count is **external link taps**; your shop, Etsy, or booking tool shows visits too.
Instagram views	The number of times your posts started playing or were shown, as Instagram Insights reports them. Replays count, so views are higher than the number of people.[14]
Inquiries	For services: quote requests, booking requests, and call requests.

The plan counts Instagram views only. Views on Facebook, Pinterest, TikTok, and YouTube are a bonus on top, because those apps send people to your page in their own ways.

The calculator, on paper

This worksheet matches the free Income Goal calculator at **scrollyseo.com/calculators**. Type the same four numbers into the calculator and it does the math for you.

EXAMPLE: HOW MANY VIEWS DOES $1,000 TAKE AT $50 AN ORDER?

Monthly revenue goal	Average order value	Visitors who buy	Viewers who visit your website
$ 1,000	$ 50	2.5 %	7.5 %

20 SALES	800 WEBSITE VISITORS	10,667 INSTAGRAM VIEWS

YOUR NUMBERS

Monthly revenue goal	Average order value	Visitors who buy	Viewers who visit your website
$ 1,000	$	%	%

_____ SALES	_____ WEBSITE VISITORS	_____ INSTAGRAM VIEWS

$1,000 ÷ average order value = sales
Sales ÷ % of visitors who buy = website visitors
Website visitors ÷ % of viewers who visit = Instagram views

ROUND UP AT EACH STEP

The two percentages are assumptions

Sales needed comes straight from your price. Visitors and views depend on two percentages you can't know until you've posted for a while, so the calculator starts with assumptions. Here's where each one comes from, and how far to trust it. Replace both with your own counts as they come in (Chapter 12).

Visitors who buy

Of the visits to your buying page, the share that end in a purchase. If 100 people visit and 2 buy, that's 2%.

Why 2.5%: it sits between two current benchmarks. Littledata's 421 Shopify stores had a median of 1.4% of visits ending in a purchase, with the top fifth above 2.6%.[15] Dynamic Yield's data from 400+ brands averages 2.66%.[16] For one clear offer, shown to people who already watched your videos, 2.5% is a reasonable hope; 1.4% is a cautious plan.

Price changes it. Cheaper things are quicker decisions. In the same Dynamic Yield data, beauty and food shops convert several times better than luxury and jewelry shops.

For services, read this as the share of visitors who become paying clients, usually through a quote, booking, or call first.

Viewers who visit your website

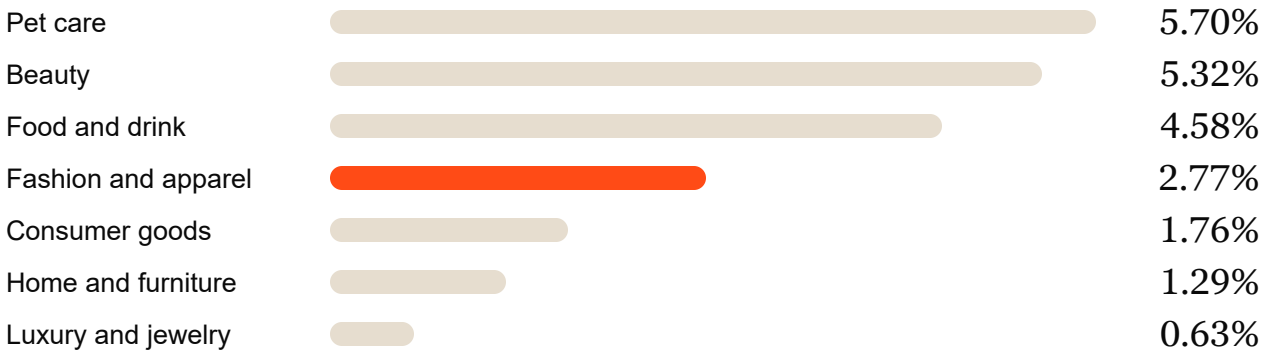
Of your Instagram views, the share that turn into a visit to your page.

About the 7.5%: no public study measures this for accounts like yours, so 7.5% is the calculator's best-case starting number. The closest public data is much lower: Databox's benchmark of 1,400+ companies shows a median of 8 website clicks a month, against a median monthly reach of about 15,000.[17] That's an average across all kinds of accounts, many of which never ask anyone to click. A focused sales month, with a clear bio link, a next step in your captions, and link stickers in Stories, should do much better. Still, plan for a lower number too: the table below shows 1% and 2.5% alongside 7.5%.

Find your own number: **Profile → Professional dashboard → Insights** , then divide **external link taps** by **views** for the same week. It's a rough rate: link taps also come from Stories and your profile, and views include replays.

SHARE OF VISITS THAT END IN A PURCHASE, BY SHOP CATEGORY

Dynamic Yield data from 400+ brands, as of June 2026



How much the assumptions matter

Here's the same $50 product with a few different assumptions. Each column is a hypothetical visit rate, and each row is a hypothetical buying rate.

Visitors who buy	1% of views visit	2.5% of views visit	7.5% of views visit
1.4% The Littledata median for Shopify stores	142,900 views	57,160 views	19,054 views
2.5% The calculator's starting number	80,000 views	32,000 views	10,667 views

Small changes in either percentage change the views you need a lot. That's why the most useful early work is often making the path easier: a clearer hook, a clearer page, a link sticker in more Stories.

The five businesses, as a planning scenario

Each business gets its own buying rate here, lower as the price rises, because bigger purchases take more trust. The rates are planning assumptions, not measurements. Views are shown at the calculator's 7.5% and at a cautious 1%.

Business	Price	Buy rate	Sales	Visitors	Views at 7.5%	Views at 1%
Paper & Pixel	$25	3%	40 kits	1,334	17,787	133,400
Sunday Supply Co.	$48	2.5%	21 bundles	840	11,200	84,000
Fix-It Frank	$250	1.5%	4 jobs	267	3,560	26,700
Golden Hour Studio	$350	1.25%	3 sessions	240	3,200	24,000
Ops Clarity	$500	1%	2 audits	200	2,667	20,000

Higher prices need fewer sales, and each sale takes more trust. Frank's four jobs might come from a dozen quote requests, so his posts focus on proof and a fast quote. Paper & Pixel needs 40 kits, so its posts focus on reach and a quick checkout. As real counts come in, each business updates its plan.

Ways to raise your average order

Raise the average order by giving buyers more of what they already want, priced so your margin and your schedule still work.

Business	Idea	Why it fits
Fix-It Frank	"Fix three things" visit at a package price	One trip covers several small repairs
Golden Hour Studio	Session plus a set of printed photos	Families want prints for the holidays
Sunday Supply Co.	Tee and tote bundle, or "buy two tees, save $8"	Same shipping, bigger order
Paper & Pixel	Party suite: invitation, signs, and thank-you cards	One theme, finished in one sitting
Ops Clarity	Audit plus a 30-day check-in call	Help putting the fixes in place

If you're in the $1K Challenge, it has its own rules for what counts as qualifying revenue. Check them in your account before day 1.

> **YOUR TURN**
>
> Fill in your numbers here or in the calculator. Write your sales number somewhere you'll see it daily, and note that the two percentages are assumptions you'll update.

Your 30-day posting schedule

This is a 30-day push. You'll start at a pace you can keep, batch the work, and add more as it gets easier.

Your starting week

Post	From 200 followers (Trial Reels)	Under 200 followers
Reels	1 new Reel idea a day, posted as 3 Trial Reels: the first version, a new hook, and a bigger edit. After 24 hours, share the best one to your feed.	1 to 2 Reels a day, posted to your followers and profile
Carousels	3 a week, with music on photo carousels	
Stories	Every day: 3 to 7 frames (Chapter 11)	
Reposts	Twice a week: repost your best-performing feed Reel with a small edit (Chapter 9)	
Replies	Every day: answer comments and messages from interested people	

When to add more

Three trials per idea is the minimum once you have Trial Reels. Add a second daily idea (three more trials) once a day's filming and editing takes you under an hour, you have ideas queued (a series helps, Chapter 9), and you're keeping up with replies. Posting more gives you more chances to be found and more to learn from; no particular number guarantees sales.

Count your work the right way

Term	What it is	Work involved
Original	A new Reel: a new idea, filmed and edited	The real work
Trial versions	The same idea with a new hook, or a bigger edit (Chapter 9)	Re-edit the same footage
Repost	A strong feed Reel posted again with a small edit	A few minutes
Placement	The same file appearing on another app	Automatic, or a minute in Buffer

At the starting pace, 30 days is about 30 Reel ideas posted as 90 Trial Reels, about 30 winners shared to your feed, 8 reposts, 12 carousels, and 30 days of Stories. Each original also lands on Facebook, Pinterest, TikTok, and YouTube, so the same work appears in well over a hundred places.

What to schedule, and what to post in the app

Schedule in Buffer	Post in the Instagram app
• TikTok and YouTube Shorts copies • Regular Reels and carousels, if you'd like them to go out at set times	• Trial Reels: tap **Trial** before you share • Stories with stickers • First comments (scheduling them is a paid Buffer feature) • Replies to comments and messages

Facebook and Pinterest follow your regular Instagram posts automatically. Trial Reels don't appear on your profile until you share them with everyone, so count on your regular Reels to reach those apps.

Running Trial Reels

About 24 hours after posting, Instagram shows each Trial Reel's views, likes, comments, and shares. If one is doing well, share it with everyone: **Profile → Reels → the Reel → View insights → Share to everyone**. Or turn on **Share to everyone automatically** under **Trial settings** before you post, and Instagram will share trials that perform well soon after publishing. Trial Reels are judged separately and don't affect how your regular Reels perform.[3]

A weekly rhythm

When	What you do
Filming day for example, Monday	Film a week of Reels in one session: several openings, the clips you need, and any voiceovers. The Social Media Quality Tips guide covers light, sound, and settings.
Editing Monday or Tuesday	Edit, export, and save every file to your camera roll.
Queue top-ups twice a week	Refill Buffer's open slots. At one video a day, 10 slots last 10 days; at three a day, about three days.
Every day 20 to 40 minutes	Post the day's Reels, your Stories, and first comments. Reply to people.
Review day for example, Sunday	The 15-minute check-in in Chapter 12.

When to post

6 to 11 p.m.

on Wednesdays and Thursdays was the strongest time for Reels in Buffer's study of 9.6 million posts. Friday and Saturday were the weakest days. Times are in each account's local time.

Buffer, 9.6 million Instagram posts

Use this as a starting test, and pick a time you can keep. After two weeks, check **Insights → Total followers → Most active times** and move toward the hours your own followers are online.[18]

> YOUR TURN
>
> Choose your filming day and your daily posting time, block them in your calendar, and film your first batch.

CHAPTER 8

Captions, on-screen text, and first comments

Your words do the selling. This chapter shows how the caption, the text on screen, what you say, and your first comment work together, with complete examples for all five businesses.

Five kinds of words on a post

Words	Where they appear	Their job
On-screen text	On the video or slide itself	Stop the scroll and say what the post is about, in a few words
Spoken words	Your voice in the video	Explain, show personality, and build trust
Speech captions	Subtitles of what you say	Let people follow along with the sound off
The caption	The text under the post	Add the useful detail and the next step
First comment	A comment you add and pin	Repeat the next step, or answer the question everyone asks

In this book, "caption" means the written text under your post. The subtitles of your speech are speech captions, covered near the end of this chapter.

Give every post a job

Every post moves the right person one step closer, and only some of them ask for the sale. Think of three jobs:

Notice

Help the right person stop and recognize their problem.

Frank: "3 things I'd never do to my own fence."

Confidence

Show how you work, answer a worry, or demonstrate the product.

Golden Hour: what happens in a 45-minute session.

Act

Invite the purchase, booking, quote, or reply.

Paper & Pixel: the kit, $25, link in bio.

Most posts mix two jobs. Whatever the job, keep the offer easy to find: your bio link, pinned posts, and a "How to buy" Highlight do that on every post, so each caption can focus on its own job.

The three parts of a caption

1. A first line worth tapping "more"

Instagram shows the first line or two before it cuts the caption off. That line needs to give the right person a reason to keep reading. Connect it to the video, then add something the video didn't say.

Restates the video	Adds a reason to read
"Here's how to fix a leaning post."	"Is your leaning fence a repair or a replace? Two quick tests will tell you."
"Our new tee!"	"One tee, three ways, all from the same drawer:"
"Family session BTS."	"What actually happens in a family session, in 45 minutes."

2. Substance: something the reader can use

Useful means the reader knows or can do something after reading. Five kinds of substance work well:

- **A clear answer:** "Push each post at chest height. One or two moving usually means a repair."
- **An explanation:** why posts rot at the soil line, or why the hour before sunset gives softer light.
- **A small story:** the toddler who ran off mid-session, and how the best photo came from it.
- **Product details:** what it's made of, what's included, how long it takes, what it costs.

- **A decision aid:** a checklist, the questions to ask, or "this one if…, that one if…"

3. A call to action (CTA)

Every caption ends by telling people what to do next. Instagram's head, Adam Mosseri, has said the signals that matter most for reach are watch time, likes, and sends (shares by message). Sends matter most for reaching people who don't follow you yet; likes matter most with your followers.[19] So a share is the most valuable thing a non-follower can do with your post.

CTA	What it does	Example
Share	The strongest signal for reaching new people	"Send this to the friend who's planning a party."
Like	A key signal for showing it to your followers	"Tap the heart if your fence looks like this."
Comment or reply	Starts a conversation you can answer	"Which number is yours? Reply and I'll tell you the first thing I'd try."
Save	Keeps your post in their collection for later	"Save this for when you're standing in front of the closet."
Follow	Brings them back for your next post	"Follow for part 2 on Thursday."
Buy, book, or quote	The sale itself	"$25, instant download. The checkout link is in my bio."

Pick one main CTA per post, matched to its job, and say it in your own words. A tip people want to pass on can ask for a share; a demo can ask for the purchase.

Short and long captions

Short: one to three sentences

When the video does the explaining: demos, before-and-afters, trend formats. The caption confirms the result and gives the next step.

Long: up to 2,200 characters

When the video is short and the value is in the words: micro-Reels, checklists, stories, and decisions.

Writing a long caption

Instagram allows up to 2,200 characters in a caption, roughly 350 to 400 words, and many micro-Reel captions use most of that. The video loops while people read, so the caption is where your value lives. Only the first line or two show before "more," so the opening has to earn the tap. Then give the full answer: every step, every tip, every outfit the video promised. Short paragraphs and a numbered list make a long caption easy to read on a phone.

LONG-CAPTION TEMPLATE

[First line: finish the thought on screen, or ask the question your buyer is asking]

[Two or three sentences: the situation your buyer knows well]

[The useful part: 3 to 7 numbered tips, steps, or ideas, each with a detail]

[How your product or service fits, with the price]

[One CTA]

[3 to 5 hashtags]

OPTIONAL: A PROMPT FOR DRAFTING WITH AI

```
Write an Instagram caption of about 1,800 characters for a short Reel
showing [what the video shows]. On screen it says "[your on-screen line]."
I sell [product or service] for [price] to [who]. Open with a line that
finishes the on-screen text. Then give [number] specific, useful [tips /
steps / ideas] about [topic], each with a concrete detail. Mention my
offer once, near the end, then end with this CTA: "[your CTA]." Use short
paragraphs, a numbered list, and 2 or 3 emojis as signposts. Plain, warm
language; no hype.
```

Read the draft against the template, swap any general phrase for a real detail from your work, and check every fact.

Emojis

A few emojis can act as signposts: one to open a list item, one to mark the price, one to point at the CTA. Two or three per caption is plenty, placed where they help someone scan; emojis in place of words make a caption harder to read.

Make it easy to read

Use short paragraphs with a blank line between them. Use a numbered list for steps or options, and plain sentences for everything else. A few sentences per paragraph reads naturally; putting every sentence on its own line makes a caption feel like a slogan.

Be specific, in your buyer's words

Specific details make a caption believable and useful. Name the product, the place, the price, the timeframe, and the question you actually hear. Instagram also reads your caption to understand what a post is about, so write the way your buyer would search: "family photographer in Denver," "fence repair," "editable birthday invitation." Use those words the way you'd say them out loud, once or twice, and keep the rest of the caption natural.

Five complete captions, annotated

One for each business, with different jobs and lengths. Each goes with a Reel in the Appendix, where you'll find the filming plan and script.

Fix-It Frank: a quote-request caption

Medium caption. Job: Confidence, then a quote request. Video: "Leaning fence: repair or replace?" (talking to camera).

Is your leaning fence a repair or a replace? Two quick tests will tell you. 👇

Push each post at chest height. If only one or two move, that's usually a repair: I reset them in fresh concrete.

Then press a screwdriver into the bottom of a board. If it sinks in easily, the wood is soft, and replacing that run is the better spend.

Still not sure? 📸 Send me a photo through the quote form in my bio. I reply the same day with a price and a date.

OPENING

Repeats the buyer's own question and promises a quick way to answer it, which gives a reason to tap "more."

SUBSTANCE

The two tests from the video, written out so people can do them in the yard.

NEXT STEP

A quote request fits a $250 service. Saying when he replies removes the worry of waiting.

Golden Hour Studio: a caption that answers the unknowns

Medium caption. Job: Confidence for first-time clients. Video: "A 45-minute family session, start to finish" (edited clips with voiceover).

What actually happens in a family session, in 45 minutes. 📸

We start with a quick game so the kids warm up. The posed photo comes once everyone's relaxed, usually halfway through. You'll see a few favorites on the camera before you leave, and your full gallery arrives within two weeks.

Sessions are $350. 🗓️ My booking page shows the dates I have open this fall.

OPENING

Promises the whole picture of a session, which is what a first-time client is unsure about.

SUBSTANCE

Walks through the session in order and answers the follow-up questions: when the posed photo happens, when photos arrive.

NEXT STEP

Price and booking page, with no pressure. The open dates on the page are real.

Sunday Supply Co.: a long caption that delivers

Long caption. Job: Ideas people save, with the offer at the end. Video: "One tee, three ways (read the caption)" (micro-Reel).

One tee, three ways, all from the same drawer:

1. 🧉 Coffee run: the tee untucked with straight-leg jeans and white sneakers. Roll the sleeves once.

2. 🧺 Farmers market: a front tuck into high-waisted jeans, the tote over your shoulder, and a denim jacket if it's cool.

3. 🥧 Dinner out: tucked into a midi skirt with a long cardigan and simple flats.

The tee is a heavier cotton, so it keeps its shape tucked or loose. The tee and tote bundle is $48, first link in my bio. Save this for the next time you stand at your closet thinking "I have nothing to wear."

OPENING

Finishes the line on screen ("One tee, three ways") and sets up a list.

SUBSTANCE

Three complete outfits with specific pieces, so the caption keeps the promise the video makes.

NEXT STEP

Two options: buy, or save for later. Both fit a post whose main job is being useful.

Paper & Pixel: a short caption after a demo

Short caption. Job: Invite the purchase. Video: "From blank kit to finished invitation" (edited clips with voiceover).

Blank kit to finished invitation in about ten minutes, all in Canva. ✨ Change the name, date, address, and colors, then text it or print it.

$25, instant download. 👉 The checkout link is in my bio.

OPENING

States the result the video shows, with the time it takes.

SUBSTANCE

Lists what buyers can change, which answers "will it work for my party?"

NEXT STEP

The video already did the explaining, so the caption gets to the price and the link quickly.

Ops Clarity: a caption that starts a conversation

Medium caption. Job: Help the right owners notice, and reply. Video: "Your designer finished Tuesday. Why did the client get it Friday?" (talking to camera).

Your designer finished Tuesday. The client got it Friday.

In most small agencies I see, those three days disappear in one of three places:

1. The files waited for an internal review nobody had scheduled.
2. The account manager didn't know they were ready.
3. Client feedback arrived in four separate emails.

Pick the one that sounds most like your team and fix it this week: a standing review slot, one "ready" message in one channel, or a single feedback form.

Which number is yours? 👇 Reply and I'll tell you the first thing I'd try.

OPENING

A specific, familiar moment. Agency owners recognize it before they finish reading.

SUBSTANCE

Three named causes and three concrete fixes. Readers get value even if they never hire her.

NEXT STEP

A reply fits a first-contact post for a $500 service. The conversation can lead to a call later.

Weak to strong: three rewrites

A product post with nothing to read

BEFORE

New drop! 🔥 🔥 Our softest tee yet. Grab yours before they're gone! Link in bio! #tee #shopsmall #cotton #fashion #style #ootd #weekend #comfy

AFTER

Our new tee is a heavier cotton that keeps its shape tucked or loose, and it gets softer every wash.

It comes in oat, black, and sage, sizes XS to 3XL. On its own it's $28, or $48 with the canvas tote.

The bundle is the first link in my bio. #cottontee #weekendoutfit #etsyshop

The rewrite swaps hype for the facts a buyer needs: fabric, colors, sizes, and prices. The hashtags drop to three that describe the post, inside Instagram's limit of five.

A service post that asks for nothing specific

BEFORE

Fence problems? I can help! Quality work at fair prices. Contact me today for all your fencing needs!

AFTER

If one or two posts in your fence are moving, a repair usually solves it. Resetting a post in fresh concrete takes me an afternoon.

Send a photo of the leaning section through the quote form in my bio, and I'll reply today with a price and a date.

The first version could describe any handyman anywhere. The rewrite describes a real situation, what the fix involves, and what happens when you reach out.

A caption that sounds AI-written

BEFORE

In today's fast-paced agency world, deadlines can feel overwhelming. It's not about working harder, it's about working smarter. 🚀 Unlock your team's full potential with a game-changing operations audit!

AFTER

Last month an agency owner told me her team works late every Thursday. We traced it back to Monday: client feedback came in through email, chat, and a shared doc, so it took two days just to collect it.

One feedback form fixed most of it.

If Thursdays feel like that at your agency, reply "Thursday" and I'll send you the form I use.

Generic phrases, contrast slogans, and big promises make a caption sound automated. The rewrite uses one concrete situation, a cause, and a small fix. If you draft with AI, replace every general phrase with a real detail from your own work. (This story is an illustration; use only real conversations, shared with permission.)

Your first comment

A first comment is optional and handy: a second place for your next step, right where people read and reply. After you post, add a comment yourself and pin it so it stays at the top.

WHAT TO WRITE

- The next step with the key detail: "Free quotes, same-day reply. The form is in my bio."
- The answer to the question people always ask: price, sizes, dates, shipping.
- A question that invites useful replies: "Which of these happens at your house?"

HOW TO PIN IT

On iPhone, swipe left on your comment and tap the **pin** icon. On Android, tap and hold it, then tap the pin. You can pin up to three comments on a post.[20]

Buffer's free plan doesn't schedule first comments, so add yours in the app after the post goes live.

On-screen text

On-screen text is often the first thing people read, and many people watch with the sound off. It carries your hook in a few words.



Orange box: the area Instagram's buttons and caption won't cover. Illustrative mockup.

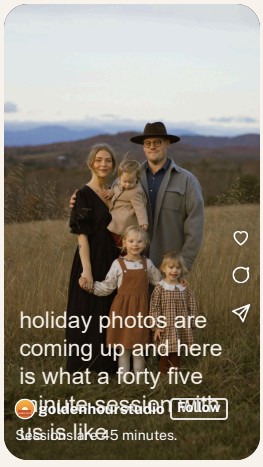
Six rules for text people can read

1. **One idea per screen,** in about 6 to 8 words.
2. **Big enough to read on a phone.** If you squint at it in the editor, make it bigger.
3. **Strong contrast.** Use the text tool's solid background over busy footage.
4. **High in the frame.** Your username, caption, and buttons cover the bottom third and the right edge.
5. **On screen long enough** to read twice.
6. **In your buyer's words,** the same ones they'd search.

Same video, two ways

Illustrative example

HARD TO READ



READABLE



Golden Hour's first version is thin, pale, too long, and sits where the caption covers it. The second is four words in a solid box, high in the frame. The rest of the message goes in the voiceover and the caption.

Auto-captions for spoken Reels

If you talk in a Reel, add captions so people can follow with the sound off. Both free options write them for you.

IN THE EDITS APP

1. Open your project and tap **Captions**.
2. Choose the language and a caption style, then tap **Generate Captions**.
3. Tap the captions layer to edit words, change the style, or move them.[21]

IN INSTAGRAM

1. In the Reels editor, tap the sticker icon.
2. Choose the **Captions** sticker; Instagram transcribes your speech.
3. Tap the captions to fix words and pick a style, then place them.

- **Read every line.** Auto-captions often get names, prices, and local words wrong; "Austin" can come out as "awesome."
- **Emphasize a word or two.** Make the price or the key result a different color, or a little bigger, so the eye catches it. Once or twice per Reel is enough.
- **Place them in the safe area,** above the caption and username and clear of the buttons.
- **Keep them in time** with your voice, a short phrase at a time.

Hashtags: up to five, at the end of your caption

Instagram allows up to five hashtags on a post; a caption or comment with more than five won't post.[22] Hashtags put your post on that hashtag's page and help Instagram understand what it's about. Mosseri has said not to count on them for extra reach.[19]

Where they go: Instagram's help page allows hashtags in the caption or the comments. Put them at the end of your caption. They're published with the post, nothing depends on remembering a comment, and Buffer's free plan can't schedule first comments anyway. Pick three to five plain ones: what it is, who it's for, and where, if you're local. For Frank: **#fencerepair #austinhandyman #homerepair**.

> **YOUR TURN**
>
> Write the caption for your next Reel: a first line that adds a reason to read, the useful substance, and a next step that fits the post's job. Then read it aloud and swap any phrase that sounds like an ad for a real detail.

CHAPTER 9

Reels

Reels reach the most new people, travel to your other apps, and can do every job: get noticed, build confidence, and ask for the sale.

Why Reels get most of your time

More reach

In Buffer's data, Reels reached 36% more people than carousels and 125% more than single images.[11]

Five places at once

One Reel also reaches Facebook and Pinterest automatically, and TikTok and YouTube through Buffer (Chapter 3).

Every job

A Reel can win a follower, a profile visit, and a sale in the same 30 seconds.

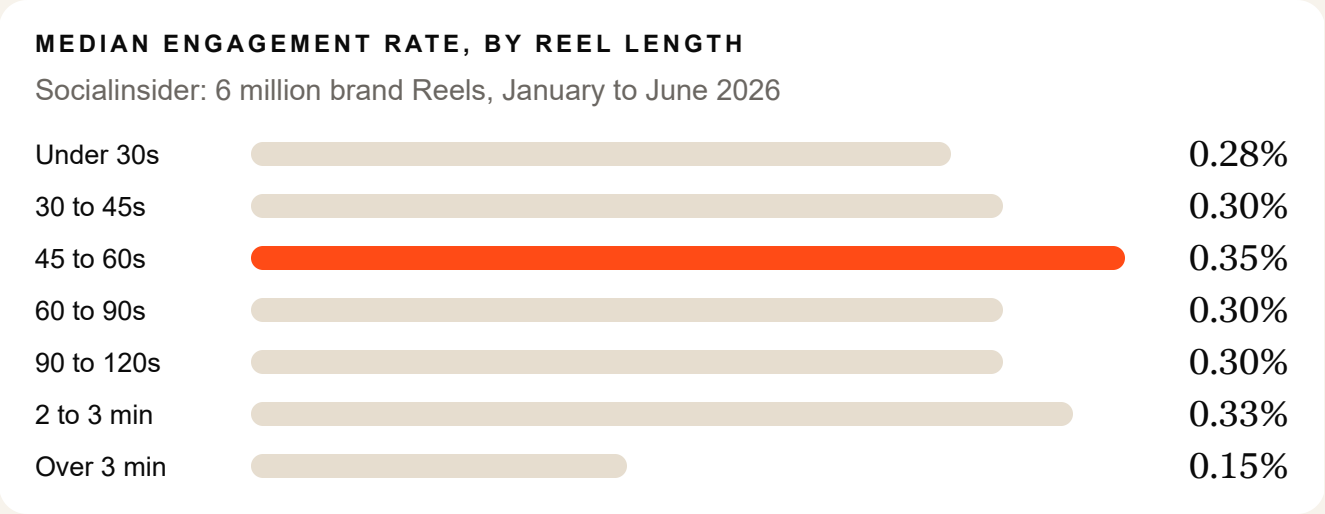
How long should a Reel be?

Instagram lets you record and edit Reels up to 20 minutes long. Reels over 3 minutes won't be recommended to people who don't follow you, so keep everything you post for reach at 3 minutes or less.[23] Within that, let the job set the length.

MEDIAN VIEWS PER REEL, BY LENGTH

Socialinsider: 6 million Reels from brand accounts, January to June 2026





In this data, Reels between 45 and 60 seconds had the most views and the highest engagement.[24] Short Reels have different strengths. A 7-second micro-Reel takes minutes to make, so you can post more often, try more ideas, and repeat a format until you know it well. Longer Reels, around 30 to 60 seconds, suit demonstrations and explanations that need the time. Use both.

The first three seconds

People decide almost instantly whether to keep watching. Your Reel insights show the **skip rate**: the share of viewers who swiped away in the first 3 seconds (Chapter 12 explains the other numbers).[25] To keep the opening strong:

- **Start on the subject:** the fence, the product, or your face, in the very first frame.
- **Put the hook on screen in the first second,** in your buyer's words.
- **Give the eyes something to notice:** movement, a close-up, or an unusual angle. The Social Media Quality Tips guide has twelve visual hooks (tips 12 to 14).

Reel covers

Your cover is the image people see on your profile grid. The grid shows each Reel cropped to a 3:4 rectangle, so the top and bottom of a full-screen cover are hidden there.

- **Size:** make the cover **1080 × 1920 px**, the same as the Reel, and keep the title and any face inside the middle **1080 × 1440 px** band.
- **Words:** use your hook, in large type with a solid background, so the grid reads like a menu of topics.

- **Series:** give every episode the same cover style and the series name, so the set is easy to spot.
- **How:** before you share, tap **Edit cover**, then pick a frame from the video or add an image from your camera roll. Instagram's help page notes the cover can't always be changed after upload, so set it first.[26]

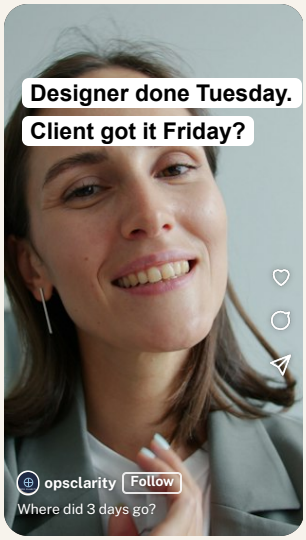
Four kinds of Reels

Mix these through your week. Each takes a different amount of time and suits a different job. The Appendix has a complete example of each format for all five businesses: what to film, the hook, the script, and the caption.

1. Talking to camera

You talk straight to the camera: a tip, an answer to a question, or a short story. People see and hear you, which builds trust quickly.

Best for	Answering questions, explaining your offer, handling a worry
How to make it	Phone at eye level, facing a window. Start with the hook as your first sentence. Keep one point per video. Add speech captions.
Length	20 to 60 seconds
Caption	A first line that adds to what you said, the key point written out, and a next step (Chapter 8).
Examples	All five businesses, starting on page 67



2. Micro-Reels with a useful caption

A short, pleasing clip with one line of on-screen text, paired with a caption that delivers what the line promises. The clip catches attention; the caption holds the value.



Best for	Posting often, tips and checklists, products that look good on camera
How to make it	One steady shot: pouring, folding, packing, panning across your work. One line on screen that names the topic, like "4 signs a fence post is rotting."
Length	5 to 10 seconds
Caption	The full answer the on-screen line promises: every sign, every step, every outfit. Then a next step.
Examples	All five businesses, starting on page 70

3. Edited clips with a voiceover

Several short clips cut together while you explain over the top. It suits processes, demos, before-and-afters, and "what happens when you buy."



Best for	Showing the work, the product, or the experience
How to make it	Film 5 to 10 short clips of each step. Record the voiceover in a quiet room (Edits has a voice tool). Change clips on each new sentence.
Length	15 to 45 seconds, with each clip 1 to 4 seconds
Caption	Often short: the result the video showed, one useful detail, and the next step.
Examples	All five businesses, starting on page 73

4. Trending formats, adapted

You borrow a popular structure (a list, a "You: / Me:" setup, a before-and-after transition) and fill it with your own footage and message.

Best for	Reaching new people with something familiar
How to make it	Save formats you like to a collection as you scroll. Copy the structure and timing with your own clips, voice, and words.
Length	Match the format
Caption	Connect the format to your buyer, add one useful detail, then the next step.
Examples	All five businesses, starting on page 75



Music and sound

Your voice, the natural sound of your work, and audio you've licensed are always safe for a business. Songs are different: Meta's music guidelines say that using music for commercial purposes or business promotion needs the right licenses.[27] Business accounts usually see a library of commercially licensed tracks for use on Instagram. Each app has its own music rights, so a song added inside Instagram doesn't carry over to TikTok or YouTube, and Pinterest mutes music it isn't licensed to use.

The simple rule: export your master file with your voice or original sound. Add a song inside each app, from that app's library, when it fits the post.

Your Trial Reel routine: 3 trials for every Reel

Trial Reels go to people who don't follow you, so they're your main tool for reaching new people and testing ideas. If your account has them, post every new Reel idea as at least three Trial Reels:

1. **Version 1.** The Reel as you first made it.
2. **A new hook.** The same Reel with a different opening line and first frame.
3. **A bigger edit.** A more substantial change: a different first clip, a new order, a tighter cut, or a different format.
4. **Check after 24 hours.** Compare the three trials' views, shares, and comments.

5 **Share the best one to your feed.** Open its insights and tap Share to everyone. The other two have done their job.

Repost your best Reel twice a week

Twice a week, look at the Reels on your feed and pick the best performer: the most shares, profile visits, inquiries, or sales. Repost it with a small edit, so people who missed it the first time get another chance to see it.

SMALL EDITS THAT WORK

- A new first line on screen
- A different first frame or cover
- Trimmed tighter, or a new ending
- A new caption and CTA

POST REPOSTS AS REGULAR REELS

Instagram says a Trial Reel may get limited reach if it detects content you've already shared,[3] so post reposts as regular Reels, not trials. To keep a repost off Pinterest, add a skip word in Pinterest's import settings (Chapter 3).

Series Reels

A series is a recurring idea with a clear promise, told across several Reels. It gives you a week of ideas from one decision, and gives viewers a reason to come back.

A series can use any of the four formats; the "series" is the promise that ties episodes together. Frank's "Repair or replace?" series answers one question about a different repair in each episode. It helps you plan and batch, keeps a recognizable structure, and lets viewers who liked one episode find the others. Instagram doesn't promise extra reach for numbered episodes; the benefits are for you and your viewers.

How to build a series

1. **Pick a recurring question, problem, demonstration, or test** your buyer cares about.
2. **Make the promise narrow enough** to hold several different episodes: "repair or replace?" works; "home tips" is too broad.
3. **Outline five episodes before you film anything.**
4. **Give each episode a complete point.** Someone who has never seen part 1 should still understand and use part 3.
5. **Lead with the episode's own hook.** The series name and number come second, as a label.
6. **Repeat a recognizable structure,** like the same opening question, setting, or text style, and vary the content.
7. **Batch the filming.** Film all five openings in one session and reuse supporting clips where they fit.
8. **Keep the offer easy to reach in every episode,** with a next step that fits, so buyers can act at any point.
9. **Then decide:** continue with five more, adjust the promise, or end it, based on the replies and interest it brings and what you can keep up.

Help people find the other episodes

- Use the same series name in the on-screen text and caption of every episode: "Repair or replace, part 3."
- In the caption, mention where to find the earlier parts: "Part 1 is on my profile."

- Use matching cover titles so the series is easy to spot on your grid.
- Share each episode to your Story and save it to a Highlight named after the series.

Fitting a series into your week

A series supplies ideas for the Reels you're already posting; it isn't an extra quota. Start with one series. Five episodes cover your new Reels for a week, and each episode becomes your three Trial Reels for that day.

A worked series: Fix-It Frank, "Repair or replace?"

Illustrative example

Promise: each episode helps a homeowner decide whether one common problem needs a repair or a replacement. **Buyer:** Austin homeowners with a repair they keep putting off. **Offer in every episode:** the quote form.

PART 1

"Leaning fence: repair or replace?"

Film: Frank beside a leaning section, pushing each post, then pressing a screwdriver into a board.

What Frank says: Two tests: count the moving posts, and check whether the boards are soft. Full script on page 67.

Caption: annotated on page 29.

Next step: Quote form

PART 2

"Soft deck board: repair or replace?"

Film: Frank kneeling on a deck, pressing a screwdriver into a board, then shining a flashlight between boards onto the joist below.

What Frank says: "If the screwdriver sinks into one or two boards, I replace just those boards. Then I check the joists, the beams the boards sit on. Solid joists mean the deck has years left. Soft joists mean that section needs rebuilding."

> Soft spot on your deck? Check what's underneath before you price a new deck.
>
> One or two soft boards: I swap them out, usually in an hour or two. Soft joists under them: that section needs rebuilding.
>
> Repair or replace, part 2. Part 1, on leaning fences, is on my profile. Send me a photo of your soft spot through the quote form in my bio.

Next step: Quote form

PART 3

"Hole in the wall: patch or new drywall?"

Film: Frank holding a mesh patch next to a doorknob-sized hole, then pointing to a larger, water-stained area in another room.

What Frank says: "A hole smaller than your fist takes a mesh patch, two thin coats of compound, and paint. Bigger than your hand, or stained around the edges, I cut out a square, fit a new piece, and find out what caused it."

> Doorknob through the wall? That's a patch: mesh, two thin coats, sand, paint. It's an easy weekend job if you'd like to try it yourself.
>
> Call someone when the hole is bigger than your hand or there's a stain around it. A stain usually means water, and that needs finding first.
>
> Repair or replace, part 3. Quote form in my bio.

Next step: Save, or quote form

PART 4

"Sticking door? Try this before a new door"

Film: A door rubbing at the top corner. Close-up of Frank tightening the top hinge screws, then swapping one for a longer screw.

What Frank says: "Most sticking doors have a loose top hinge. Tighten the screws. If one spins, swap it for a longer screw that reaches the frame. Still rubbing? I plane a little off the edge. A new door makes sense when it's cracked or warped."

> Before you replace a sticking door, check the top hinge. Loose screws let the door drop and rub.
>
> Tighten them. If one keeps spinning, swap it for a 3-inch screw that bites into the frame. That fixes most of them in five minutes.
>
> Still sticking after that? I can plane the edge or rehang it. Repair or replace, part 4.

Next step: Save, then quote if needed

PART 5

"Gate won't latch: repair or replace?"

Film: A sagging gate missing its latch. Frank checks the hinge post with a level, then fits a diagonal brace kit.

What Frank says: "When a gate sags, the latch misses. Check the hinge post first. If it leans, the post needs resetting. If the post is straight, the gate has sagged, and a diagonal brace pulls it back square."

> Gate won't latch anymore? Put a level on the hinge post first.
>
> Leaning post: it needs resetting in concrete, the same fix as part 1. Straight post: the gate itself has sagged, and a diagonal brace kit pulls it square again.
>
> That's the end of Repair or replace. Thanks for following along. Which repair should I cover next? Tell me in the comments.

Next step: Comment; quote form

Parts 3 and 4 give away a fix many people can do themselves. That generosity builds trust, and the people who'd rather not do it themselves know exactly who to ask.

Five-episode outlines for the other four businesses

Golden Hour Studio: "Before your family photo session"

Part	Episode hook	What to film
1	What to wear	Holding up two outfits in the studio
2	The best time of day	A family walking in evening light
3	"My kids won't sit still"	A toddler running, then the final photo
4	Bringing the dog	A dog on a leash in a family session
5	What happens after	Scrolling a gallery; a print in hand

Sunday Supply Co.: "One tee, five outfits"

Part	Episode hook	What to film
1	The coffee run	Tee, jeans, sneakers, walking to a café
2	The farmers market	A front tuck, the tote on your shoulder
3	Under a blazer	The tee with a blazer for a casual workday
4	Dinner out	Tucked into a midi skirt with a cardigan
5	When it turns cold	Layered under an open flannel

Paper & Pixel: "Invitation mistakes"

Part	Episode hook	What to film
1	An RSVP with no "who" or "how"	Editing the RSVP line on screen
2	No map link	Tapping a map link on a phone invitation
3	Fonts nobody can read	Swapping a thin script font for a clear one
4	No end time	Adding "2 to 4 p.m." to the invitation
5	Sending too late	A calendar counting back three weeks

Ops Clarity: "Where the work gets stuck"

Part	Episode hook	What to film
1	The brief that changes midway	A brief with three versions on screen
2	The review nobody scheduled	A calendar with no review slot
3	Feedback in four places	Email, chat, a doc, and a voice note
4	The handoff with no owner	A project board with an unassigned task
5	The "quick sync" that eats Thursday	Three meetings stacked on one afternoon

WORKSHEET: YOUR FIRST SERIES

SERIES NAME AND PROMISE _____

BUYER _____

	EPISODE HOOK	FOOTAGE NEEDED
Part 1		
Part 2		
Part 3		
Part 4		
Part 5		

THE OFFER AND NEXT STEP EACH EPISODE POINTS TO

_____

YOUR TURN

Fill in the worksheet for one series, then film all five openings in one session this week.

CHAPTER 10

Carousels

Carousels earn the most engagement of any post type. They're where people get to know how you work and decide to buy.

The carousel rules

Add music before you tap Share.

Tap **Add music** on the screen before the caption.[13] Since July 2026, Instagram also lets you replace the song on a published post,[28] and adding a track while you post is still the dependable way to make sure the carousel has one. Music works on photo carousels; carousels that include a video can't have music added.

Make slides 1 and 2 both strong.

If someone scrolls past, Instagram may show the carousel again starting on slide 2.[12] Each of the first two slides should make sense alone and make people want to swipe.

Use 5 to 10 slides.

Instagram allows up to 20. Five to ten gives you room to teach or prove something. Use as many as the point needs.

One idea per slide.

About 25 words or fewer, in large type, with a margin around the edges.

End with a next step that fits.

A save, a reply, a quote, or a purchase, on the last slide and in the caption.

When to show a person, hands, or the product

Choose the picture that helps the reader understand or trust the offer. A face helps when you're the product: a photographer, a consultant, a coach. Hands help when the skill is the point: resetting a post, folding a tee, editing an invitation. A close product shot helps when details matter: fabric, print quality, packaging. A clean text slide works well for a list or a single strong idea.

Size and setup

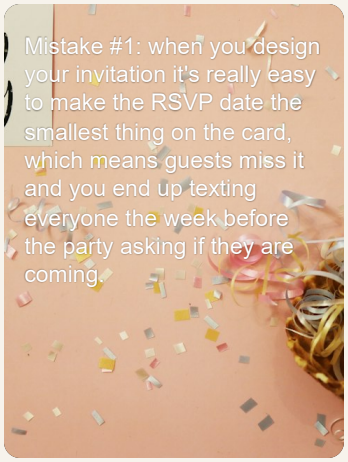
Make every slide **1080 × 1440 px** (a 3:4 shape). Instagram keeps photos at full quality up to that size, and the shape fills the most screen space.[29] Keep all slides the same size so

none get cropped differently. To post: **+ → Post → Select multiple → choose slides in order → Next → Add music → caption → Share** .

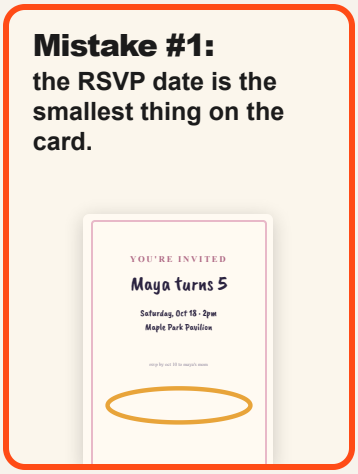
Make every slide easy to read

People read carousels on a phone, a second or two per slide. Give each slide one idea, in large type on a calm background, with a margin around the edges.

HARD TO READ



READABLE



Paper & Pixel's first try puts about 45 small words over confetti. The fix says the same mistake in eleven words on a plain background, then shows it on the invitation. The full explanation moves to the caption.

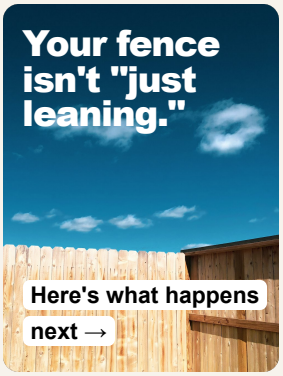
Five carousels, start to finish

Here is one complete carousel for each business: seven slides, swiped in order, with its caption underneath. Each business uses a different structure.

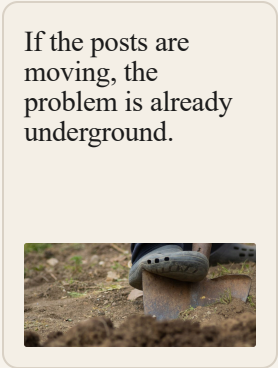
Fix-It Frank: one carousel, 7 slides

Illustrative example

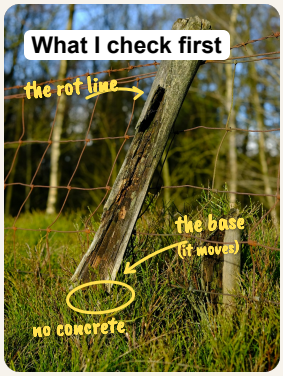
Structure: Problem, explanation, fix, next step. **Job:** Notice and confidence. Each slide uses a different design, all on the same 3:4 canvas.



Slide 1: type over photography



Slide 2: minimal statement + one real object



Slide 3: annotated photo



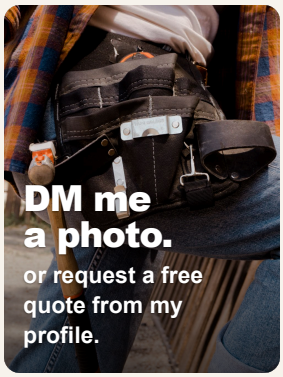
Slide 4: notes-app list



Slide 5: real job photo + caption



Slide 6: scrapbook snapshots



Slide 7: snapshot + big type

CAPTION

Not sure if your fence needs a repair or a replacement? Swipe through the checks I do first. 👉

If the posts are moving, the problem is underground, usually rot at the soil line. One or two loose posts can be reset in fresh concrete in an afternoon. A whole run of soft boards is when replacing makes more sense.

Send me a photo of yours through the quote form in my bio and I'll tell you which it is, with a price, the same day.

Golden Hour Studio: one carousel, 7 slides

Illustrative example

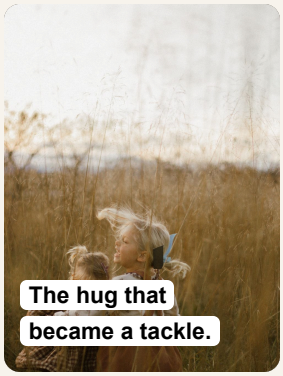
Structure: A worry, the answer, the plan, next step. **Job:** Confidence. Each slide uses a different design, all on the same 3:4 canvas.



Slide 1: type over photography

The best family photos happen in the moments between poses.

Slide 2: minimal statement



Slide 3: real session photo + caption



Slide 4: photo + handwritten note

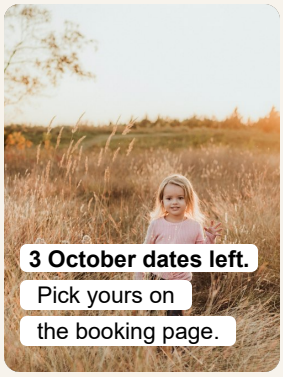


Slide 5: polaroid snapshot

The 45 minutes

10 min: games, no camera pressure
20 min: walking and playing
5 min: the posed photo
10 min: whatever happens

Slide 6: the session plan



Slide 7: snapshot + direct ask

CAPTION

"My kids won't sit still." I hear it before almost every session, and it's fine. Some of my favorite photos happen when they don't.

Here's how the 45 minutes usually go: a few games first so nobody feels watched, then walking and playing, and the posed photo once everyone has relaxed.

I have three October dates left: the 12th, 14th, and 19th. The booking page is in my bio.

Sunday Supply Co.: one carousel, 7 slides

Illustrative example

Structure: One product, real days, the offer. **Job:** Notice, then act. Each slide uses a different design, all on the same 3:4 canvas.



Slide 1: type over photography



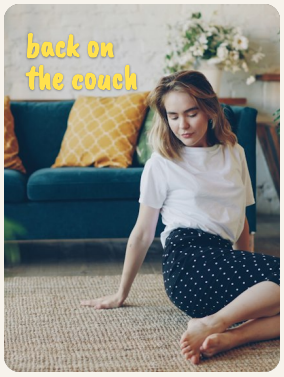
Slide 2: split: two photos, one idea



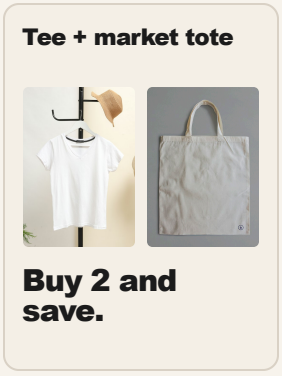
Slide 3: real-life photo + time stamp



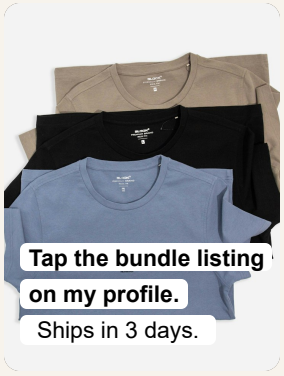
Slide 4: scrapbook snapshot



Slide 5: photo + handwritten note



Slide 6: product pair + offer



Slide 7: snapshot + direct ask

CAPTION

The outfit for a Sunday with zero plans: the tee on the couch, the same tee at the farmers market, and back on the couch by noon.

It's a heavier cotton that stays soft, and the canvas tote holds a full market haul. Together they're $48, and orders ship within three days. 📦

The bundle is the first link in my bio.

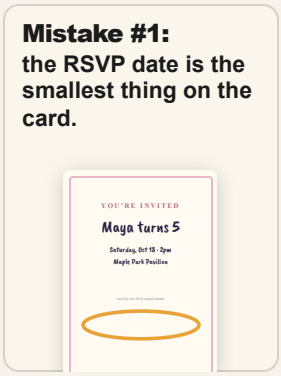
Paper & Pixel: one carousel, 7 slides

Illustrative example

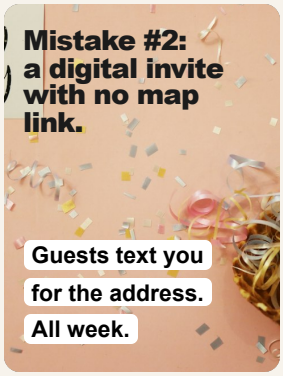
Structure: Three mistakes, the fix, next step. **Job:** Notice and act. Each slide uses a different design, all on the same 3:4 canvas.



Slide 1: oversized type over photo



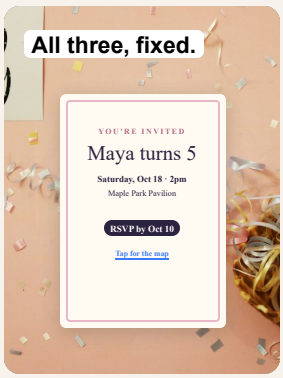
Slide 2: annotated product



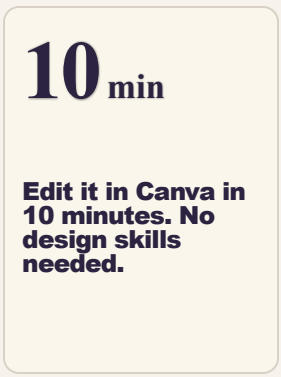
Slide 3: big type, one consequence



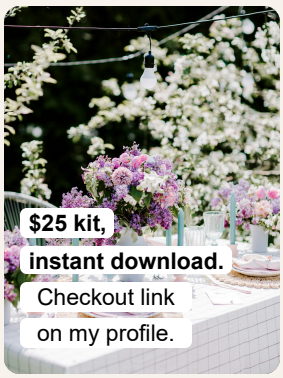
Slide 4: show the problem



Slide 5: the product, fixed



Slide 6: big number



Slide 7: snapshot + direct ask

CAPTION

Three invitation mistakes that leave you chasing RSVPs:

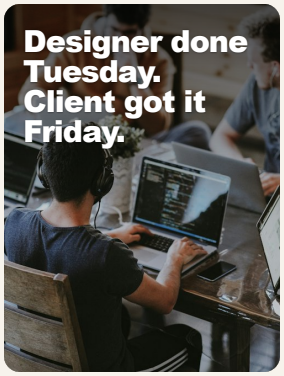
1. The RSVP line is the smallest thing on the card.
2. A digital invite with no map link.
3. A pretty script font nobody can read on a phone.

Every Paper & Pixel kit fixes all three, and you finish it in Canva in about ten minutes. ✨ $25, instant download, checkout link in my bio.

Ops Clarity: one carousel, 7 slides

Illustrative example

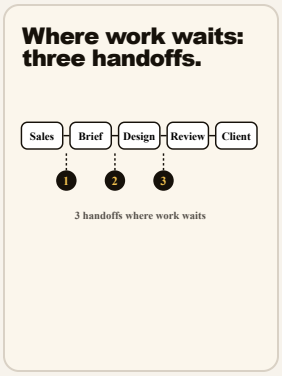
Structure: A familiar delay, the cause, how to find it. **Job:** Notice, then reply. Each slide uses a different design, all on the same 3:4 canvas.



Slide 1: type over photography



Slide 2: minimal statement



Slide 3: diagram / explainer



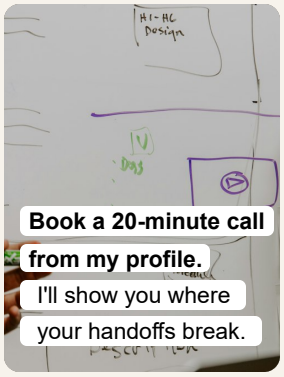
Slide 4: numbered list



Slide 5: how to spot it



Slide 6: question slide



Slide 7: snapshot + direct ask

CAPTION

Your designer finished Tuesday. The client got it Friday. Those three days usually disappear at a handoff: a review nobody scheduled, files nobody knew were ready, or feedback scattered across four places.

Swipe for three fixes to try, and a simple way to find where your team's work waits.

Which of the three sounds like your team? Reply with the number. If it's more than one, a free 20-minute call is the first step of my audit, link in bio.

YOUR TURN

Pick the structure closest to your business and make your first carousel: 5 to 10 slides at 1080 × 1440, music added before you share, and a next step on the last slide and in the caption.

CHAPTER 11

Stories

Stories are seen mostly by people who already follow you. That makes them the best place to answer questions and invite warm followers to buy.

How Stories fit the plan

Reels and carousels bring new people in. Stories keep you in front of the followers you've won, every day, and make it easy for them to ask a question or tap through to buy. Stories aren't part of the views in your calculator, so count them as a bonus that helps people already watching say yes.

Every day

Post Stories daily during your 30 days.

3 to 7 frames

Enough to tell a small story before people tap away.

About 1 in 4 invites

Make most frames helpful or behind the scenes, and about one in four an invitation to buy or book.

Use stickers to start conversations

Sticker	Use it to
Poll	Learn what people are thinking about: "What keeps getting pushed down your repair list? Fence / Deck."
Question box	Collect real questions to answer in your next Stories, Reels, and carousels.
Emoji slider	Get a quick, low-effort reaction to something you've made.
Link	Send people straight to your checkout, booking page, or quote form.

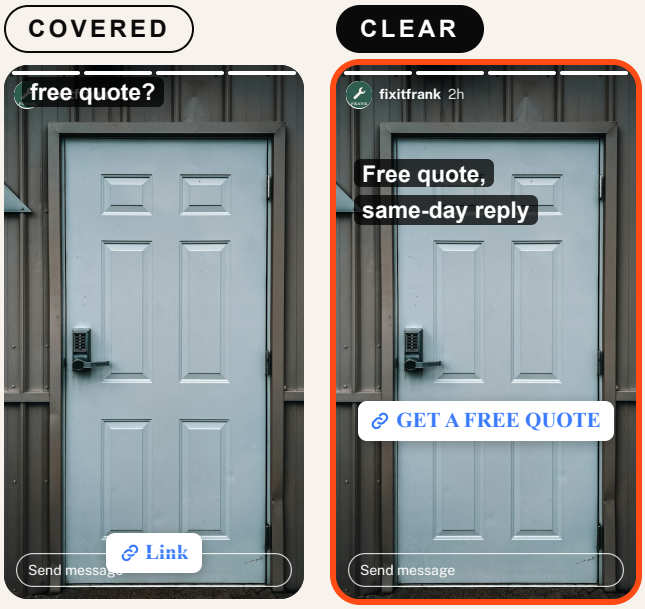
A vote or a slider tells you what people are interested in. It doesn't give you permission to send them sales messages; reply to people who message you, and keep the invitation in your Stories.

Link stickers

Every account can add link stickers to Stories, at any follower count.[30] Add one: **Create your Story → sticker icon → Link → paste your link → Customize sticker text**. Change the text to say what people get, like "Pick your date," "Get a free quote," or "$25 kit, instant download," instead of the bare web address.

Keep text and stickers clear

Your name sits across the top of every Story and the reply bar across the bottom. Put one line of text and one sticker in the middle of the frame, and make the link sticker say what people get.



On the left, Frank's text hides under his name, and a sticker that only says "Link" sits behind the reply bar. On the right, the text is clear of both, and the sticker says what you get, right where a thumb lands.

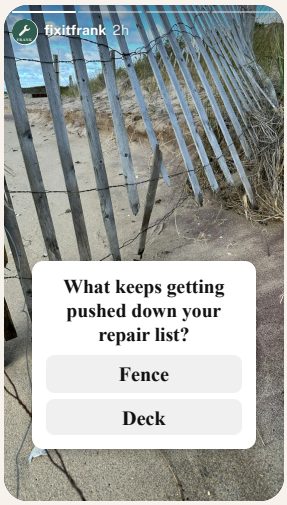
The 4-frame selling sequence

Each sequence moves from a question or problem, to proof or a demonstration, to the answer, to the invitation. Here it is for all five businesses.

1. Question or problem → **2. Proof or demo** → **3. Answer or result** → **4. The invitation**

Fix-It Frank: repair poll

Illustrative example



1. POLL STICKER



2. THE CHECK, ON VIDEO



3. WHAT IT MEANS

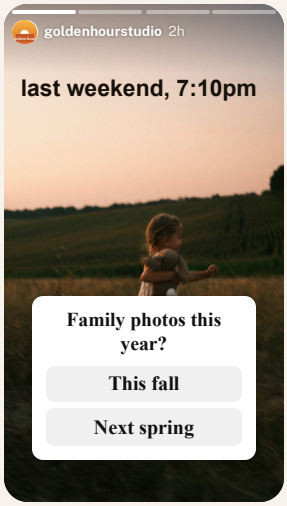


4. LINK STICKER

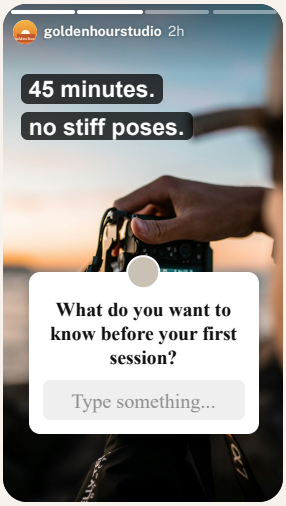
What it tells the owner: The poll tells Frank which repair people are thinking about. "Fence" won, so frame 2 shows the fence check. Next week's Stories can cover decks for the people who voted that way.

Golden Hour Studio: fall dates

Illustrative example



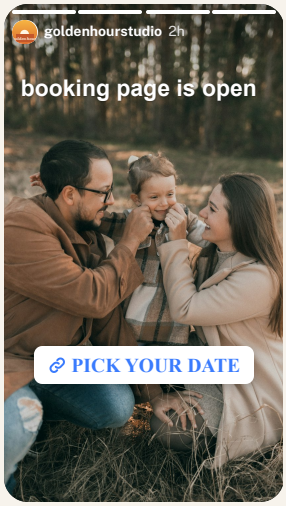
1. POLL STICKER



2. QUESTION STICKER



3. REAL AVAILABILITY

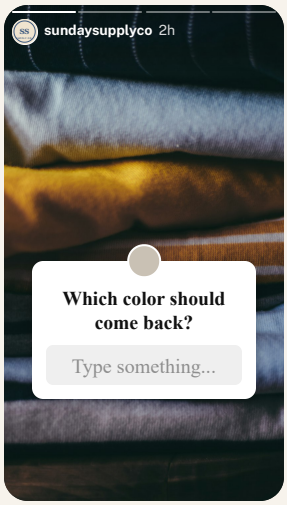


4. LINK STICKER

What it tells the owner: The poll shows who is planning for fall, and the question box collects real worries to answer in her next Reels. Only then does she share her actual open dates.

Sunday Supply Co.: restock

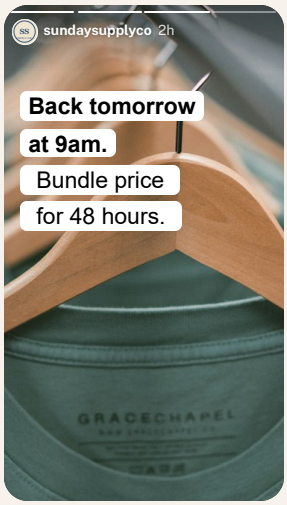
Illustrative example



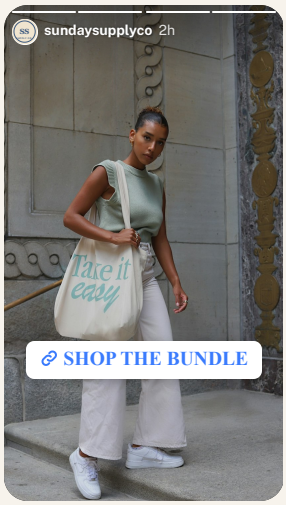
1. QUESTION STICKER



2. BEHIND THE SCENES



3. THE NEWS



4. LINK STICKER

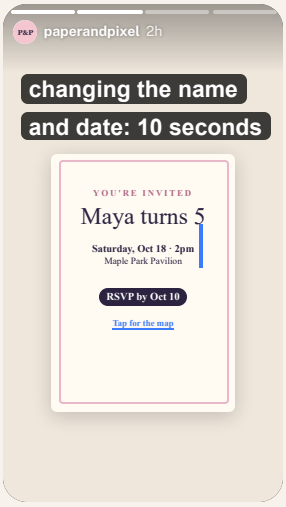
What it tells the owner: The color question tells her which shade to restock and gives followers a say, so they're watching when it returns.

Paper & Pixel: demo

Illustrative example



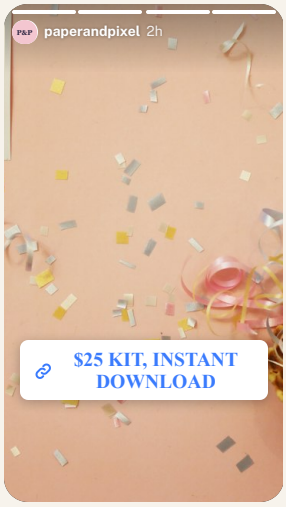
1. THE PROBLEM



2. 10-SECOND SCREEN RECORDING



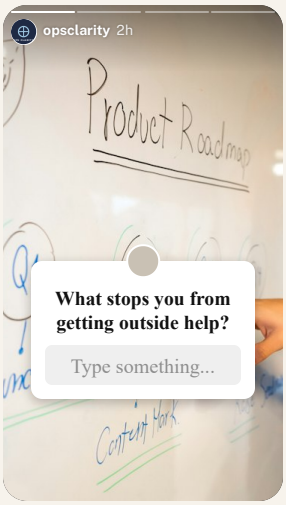
3. THE RESULT



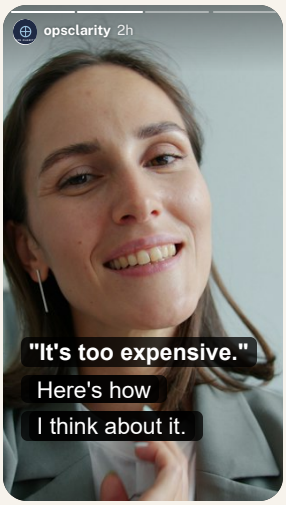
4. LINK STICKER

What it tells the owner: A 10-second screen recording answers "is this hard?" faster than any description. Link taps and sales show whether the demo worked.

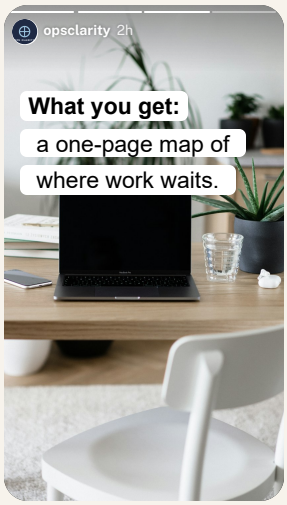
Ops Clarity: a common worry *Illustrative example*



1. QUESTION BOX



2. ANSWER ON CAMERA



3. WHAT YOU GET



4. LINK STICKER

What it tells the owner: Question-box replies are the real objections. Each one can become a Story answer, a carousel, or a Reel.

Keep your best Stories working

Stories disappear after 24 hours unless you save them. Add your best ones to **Highlights** on your profile, grouped as "How to buy," "FAQ," and, once you have them, "Reviews," so new visitors can find them anytime.

> YOUR TURN
>
> Post your first 4-frame sequence today, ending with a link sticker that says what people get. Save it to a "How to buy" Highlight.

CHAPTER 12

Review what's working

Once a week, look at two things separately: how your content is being watched, and what is happening in your business. Each one points to a different next step.

A post can hold attention and still attract people who won't buy. A post with modest views can bring the one inquiry that becomes a $500 audit. Looking at content and business separately helps you see both.

A. Content review: what to work on next

The numbers, in plain words

Open any Reel, then **View insights**. Instagram defines these numbers this way:[14,25]

Number	What it means
Views	How many times the Reel started playing, including replays.
Watch time	The total time people spent playing it, replays included.
Average watch time	Watch time divided by the number of first plays.
Skip rate	The share of viewers who swiped away in the first 3 seconds. It's about the opening only.
Retention chart	The share of viewers still watching at each moment of the Reel.
Shares, saves, follows	Signs the Reel was useful or interesting enough to act on, where Instagram shows them.

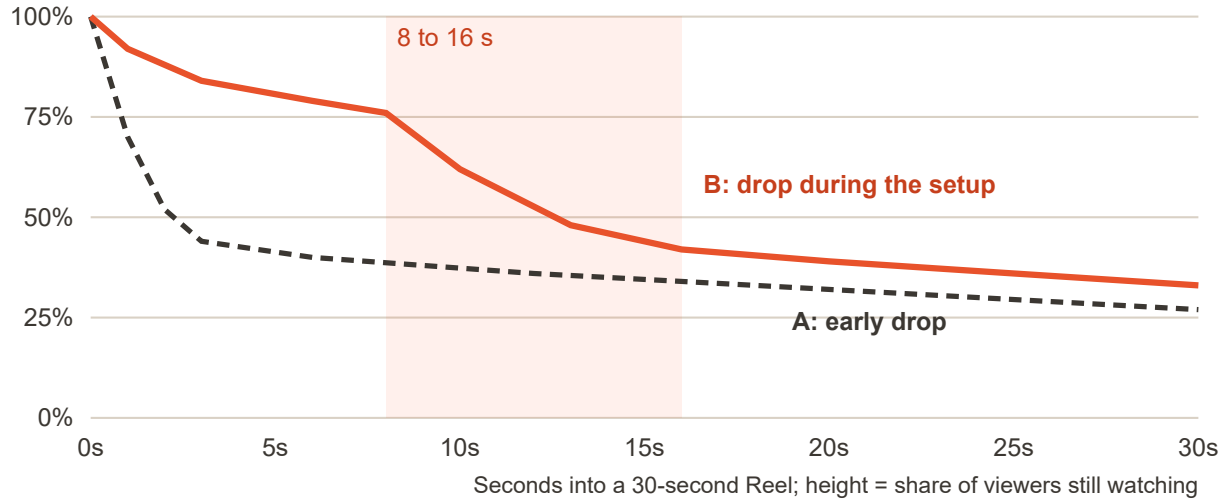
Not every account or Reel shows every number. Use what you have.

What average watch time can and can't tell you

Say a 30-second Reel has an average watch time of 12 seconds. That's the average time spent watching. It doesn't mean everyone left at second 12: some watched three seconds, some watched twice. Average watch time divided by length (12 ÷ 30 = 40%) is a rough way to compare your Reels of similar length. Replays can push it up, so treat it as a comparison, never as the share of people who finished.

The retention chart is more useful for finding *when* people leave. It still can't tell you *why*, so use it to choose a passage to look at, then make your best guess and try a change.

TWO RETENTION PATTERNS *Illustrative schematic, not real data*



A: early drop. Many viewers are gone by second 3, and the rest stay. The opening is where to look. **Before:** Frank's Reel opened on a wide shot of the yard while he said, "Hey everyone, today I want to talk about fences." **After:** it opens on his hand pushing a wobbling post, with "Leaning fence: repair or replace?" on screen.

B: drop during the setup. The opening holds, then viewers leave between 8 and 16 seconds. **Before:** Golden Hour spent those seconds explaining how long she's been a photographer. **After:** she cut that part and went straight to the first clip of the session, moving her background to the caption.

What you see, what to look at, what to try

What you see	What to look at	One change to try
Many viewers leave in the first seconds	The first frame, whether the topic is clear, whether the text is readable, whether the promise matters to your buyer	Start on the subject and make the benefit or question clear in the first second
The opening holds, then people leave during the setup	Long introductions, repeated context, a slow lead-in to the useful part	Cut the setup and show the useful action or example sooner
A clear drop in the middle of the explanation	Confusing words, hard-to-read text, weak audio, a still or repeated stretch	Simplify that part, fix the sound, or show a relevant clip while you talk
People leave before the promised result	A payoff that arrives late, or a video longer than the idea needs	Show the result sooner and tighten the rest
Good viewing compared with your similar posts, but little useful interest	Whether the topic fits your buyer, the message, your profile, and the next step	Make the link to your offer clearer, while keeping the post useful
Modest views, but a real inquiry or sale	The topic, the proof, the explanation, and the buying path that worked	Make another useful version of that idea

These are starting points for a guess, not rules. Compare a Reel with your own similar Reels: a trial with other trials, a 7-second loop with other short loops, a talking video with other talking videos. Different lengths and audiences produce different curves.

No chart? Watch your Reel once, with the sound off, as if you'd never seen it. Note the second where you'd scroll away. Then compare its average watch time and shares with your last few similar Reels, and read the comments for questions or confusion.

B. Business review: a 15-minute weekly check-in

Once a week, write down a few counts. Use your shop, booking, or quote tool, your messages, and Instagram Insights.

Week	Posted	Posts that brought interest	Inquiries or link taps	Sales or bookings	Revenue this week	Still needed
1						
2						
3						
4						

Golden Hour Studio, week 1

Illustrative example

Count	This week
Posted	7 Reel ideas as 21 trials, 7 shared to the feed, 2 reposts, 3 carousels, Stories on 6 days
Posts that brought interest	The "what to wear" Reel (4 people saved it and 2 asked about fall dates) and the fall-dates Story sequence
Inquiries	3 people asked about dates
Bookings and revenue	1 session booked and paid: $350
Still needed	$650, about 2 more sessions

REPEAT

Another useful planning Reel, like the best time of day for photos.

IMPROVE

Two people asked about price before booking, so add "from $350" to the booking page headline.

NEXT

Post the fall-dates Story sequence twice next week, with the real open dates.

Use counts, and leave unknowns blank

"Three people asked about dates and one booked" is clear and useful. It's too few to call a conversion rate, to decide a format doesn't work, or to rebuild your offer. If you didn't track something, leave it blank: blank means unknown, and zero means you checked and nothing happened. If your calculator still uses the starting assumptions because you have only a few sales, that's fine. A thin week still has useful work in it: fix a broken link, an unreadable hook, a wrong price, or an unanswered message, and keep posting.

> **YOUR TURN**
>
> Pick your review day. At the end of week one, fill in the log and write one Repeat, one Improve, and one Next.

CHAPTER 13

Your 30 days, start to finish

Thirty days of steady posting is a real workload. This plan keeps it manageable by batching the work, scheduling what can be scheduled, and reusing ideas that work.

How the plan keeps the work manageable

Batch on one day.
Film a week of openings and clips in one session, then edit in one sitting (Chapter 7).

Schedule what you can.
Queue TikTok and YouTube copies, and any regular posts, in Buffer. Top up the queue twice a week.

Let a series supply ideas.
One series gives you five Reels from one decision (Chapter 9).

Reuse what works.
Twice a week, repost your best feed Reel with a small edit (Chapter 9).

If you'd like more structure, the $1K Challenge adds a Notion content tracker and an auto-posting setup for Buffer (next page).

Before day 1

- [ ] Offer sentence written, and the phone check done (Chapter 2)
- [ ] Instagram, Facebook, Pinterest, TikTok, YouTube, and Buffer set up and connected (Chapter 3)
- [ ] Bio and link updated (Chapter 4)
- [ ] Your $1K numbers written down, with the assumptions noted (Chapter 6)
- [ ] Filming day and posting time in your calendar (Chapter 7)
- [ ] Your first series outlined (Chapter 9)

Every week

- [ ] One filming session and one editing session
- [ ] A new Reel idea each day, posted as 3 Trial Reels from 200 followers, with the best shared to your feed (Chapters 7 and 9)
- [ ] Three carousels, with music on photo carousels (Chapter 10)
- [ ] Stories every day, with a link sticker about one frame in four (Chapter 11)
- [ ] Replies to everyone who asks a question (Chapter 2)
- [ ] Two reposts of your best feed Reel, each with a small edit (Chapter 9)
- [ ] The 15-minute check-in: Repeat, Improve, Next (Chapter 12)

What you can do now

- Name what you sell, who it's for, and where they buy it.
- Work out how many sales your $1,000 takes, and what the views estimate depends on.
- Choose the right kind of post for each job, and write its caption.
- Plan a series, film a Reel on your phone, and publish it to five apps.
- Read your Reel insights, and decide one useful thing to try next.

> **YOUR TURN**
>
> Start today with Chapter 2: write your offer sentence and tap through your own bio link on your phone.

Want Scrolly to run this with you?

This Playbook and the Social Media Quality Tips guide teach the whole method. The $1K Challenge adds a 30-day structure on top, for people who like a deadline and a weekly check-in.

Your personal $1K Plan: your numbers, what to do each week, and a weekly check-in.

25 Reel ideas every week: current formats, ready to film.

60 Canva templates: 30 carousel and 30 Story templates.

A Notion content tracker: plan and track every post in one place.

An auto-posting setup for Buffer: your videos go into your Buffer queue for YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram.

30 consecutive days, one goal: $1,000 in revenue, tracked in your account.

If you bought the Club with the Challenge, all of this is already in your Scrolly account. If you bought the Club on its own, you can add the Challenge from your account whenever you're ready to start your 30 days.

Earn your stripe.

Reach $1,000 in revenue within your 30 consecutive Challenge days and verify it with your sales records. You earn your stripe, and the shirt that goes with it.

The Challenge rules in your account explain what counts as qualifying revenue and how verification works.



Appendix: 20 Reel examples

Format	Fix-It Frank	Golden Hour Studio	Sunday Supply Co.	Paper & Pixel	Ops Clarity
Talking to camera	p. 67	p. 68	p. 68	p. 69	p. 69
Micro-Reel with a useful caption	p. 70	p. 71	p. 71	p. 71	p. 72
Edited clips with a voiceover	p. 73	p. 73	p. 74	p. 74	p. 75
Trending format, adapted	p. 75	p. 76	p. 76	p. 77	p. 77

Talking to camera

Fix-It Frank: Leaning fence: repair or replace?

Buyer and job	An Austin homeowner whose fence has started to lean. Give them the confidence to ask for a quote.
What to film	Frank beside a leaning section of fence, phone on a tripod at eye level, about 2 meters back at 2x. Two close-up clips: his hand pushing a post, and a screwdriver pressed into the bottom of a board.
Opening	Frank pushes the leaning panel and it wobbles. On screen: **"Leaning fence: repair or replace?"**
Script	"If your fence is leaning, ask two questions before you pay for a new one. First: how many posts are moving? Push each one. If it's one or two, that's usually a repair. I reset those posts in concrete and the fence stands straight again. Second: are the boards still solid? Press a screwdriver into the bottom of a board. If it sinks in, the wood is soft, and replacing that run makes more sense. Not sure which yours is? Send me a photo and I'll tell you."
Caption	Annotated in Chapter 8: "a quote-request caption," page 29.
Next step	Request a quote through the form in his bio.
Why it works	The hook is the exact question his buyers type into Google. Showing the two tests proves he knows the work, with no reviews needed.

Golden Hour Studio: What to wear for family photos

Buyer and job	Parents planning fall family photos in Denver. Help them feel ready, and remind them she has sessions.
What to film	The photographer in her studio holding up two outfits: a patterned dress and a plain sweater. One cutaway of a family in coordinated colors (from her own work, with permission).
Opening	She lifts the patterned dress toward the lens. On screen: **"What to wear for family photos"**
Script	"Here's what I tell every family before a session. Start with one outfit that has a pattern, usually the youngest's, and dress everyone else in two colors from it. Skip big logos and neon; they pull eyes away from faces. And bring a backup outfit for the little ones. Snacks happen. When you book, I send you this list so you don't have to remember it."
Caption	👗 What to wear for family photos, the short version: 1. Choose one patterned outfit first. 2. Pull two colors from it for everyone else. 3. Skip big logos and neon. 4. Pack a backup for the youngest. Save this for when you're standing in front of the closet. Fall sessions are 45 minutes, $350, and the booking page shows the dates I have open.
Next step	Save the post, then visit the booking page.
Why it works	A packing-list style answer is easy to save and share with a partner. The session details sit at the end, for parents who are ready.

Sunday Supply Co.: How to keep a cotton tee soft

Buyer and job	People who buy a few good basics and wear them for years. Show care and quality, so the price feels fair.
What to film	The owner at a folding table, a tee in hand. Close-up of her stretching the fabric toward the lens, then turning the tee inside out.
Opening	She turns the tee inside out in one quick move. On screen: **"How to keep a cotton tee soft"**
Script	"Three habits keep a cotton tee soft for years. Wash it cold and inside out, so the outside rubs less. Skip fabric softener; it coats the fibers and makes them feel stiff over time. And air-dry, or tumble on low. We chose a heavier cotton for our tees because it holds its shape through all of that."

Caption	🧺 Three habits for a tee that stays soft: Cold wash, inside out. No fabric softener. Air-dry, or tumble on low. Our tees are a heavier cotton, picked to hold their shape wash after wash. The tee and tote bundle is $48, and it's the first link in my bio.
Next step	Tap the bundle link.
Why it works	Care tips are useful even to people who never buy, so they get saved and shared. The product detail fits naturally after the tips.

Paper & Pixel: The RSVP line most invitations get wrong

Buyer and job	A parent planning a child's birthday party. Solve a small, familiar annoyance and introduce the kit.
What to film	The owner talking to camera, holding her phone up to show an invitation on screen. One screen-recording clip of the RSVP line being edited.
Opening	She holds the phone so the invitation fills the frame. On screen: **"The RSVP line most invitations get wrong"**
Script	"Most invitations say 'RSVP by the 10th' and stop there. So guests ask: RSVP to who? How? Add one line: who to tell, how to reach them, and by when. 'Text Jess at 555-0142 by Friday the 10th.' That one line saves you a week of chasing replies. Every one of my kits has it built in."
Caption	One line that saves you a week of chasing RSVPs: say who to tell, how to reach them, and by when. "Text Jess at 555-0142 by Friday the 10th." Every Paper & Pixel kit has an RSVP line ready to edit. $25, instant download, link in my bio.
Next step	Buy the kit.
Why it works	The fix works with or without her product, which builds trust. The phone number is a made-up example, clearly in a template format.

Ops Clarity: Your designer finished Tuesday. Why did the client get it Friday?

Buyer and job	The owner of a 5 to 15 person creative agency. Get the right owners to recognize the problem and reply.
What to film	The consultant at her desk, close and slightly below eye level, talking with her hands. One cutaway: a calendar showing Tuesday and Friday.

Opening	She taps Tuesday on a paper calendar, then Friday. On screen: **"Your designer finished Tuesday. Why did the client get it Friday?"**
Script	"Your designer finished the files on Tuesday. The client got them on Friday. Where did three days go? In the small agencies I work with, it's usually one of three places. The files waited for an internal review nobody had scheduled. The account manager didn't know they were ready. Or the client's feedback arrived in four different emails. Pick one and fix it this week: a fixed review slot, one 'ready' message in one channel, or a single feedback form."
Caption	Annotated in Chapter 8: "a caption that starts a conversation," page 31.
Next step	Reply with the number of the delay that sounds familiar, or book a call.
Why it works	A specific, recognizable delay works better than a general claim about efficiency. Each fix is usable today, which shows how she thinks.

Micro-Reel with a useful caption

Fix-It Frank: 4 signs a fence post is rotting (read the caption)

Buyer and job	Homeowners who've noticed something off about their fence. Teach a quick check people save, and keep Frank in mind for later.
What to film	One 6-second shot: a slow pan down a fence post to the soil line, where the wood is dark and soft.
Opening	The pan starts at the top of the post. On screen: **"4 signs a fence post is rotting (read the caption)"**
Caption	🔎 Four signs a fence post is rotting: 1. The post moves when you push it at chest height. 2. The wood at ground level is darker than the rest. 3. A screwdriver sinks into the base with light pressure. 4. The fence leans more after rain. One or two of these on a single post usually means a repair: I reset the post in concrete. Several posts in a row usually means it's time to replace that run. Save this for your next walk around the yard. If you spot any of these, send me a photo through the quote form in my bio.
Next step	Save the post; request a quote if a sign shows up.
Why it works	The caption delivers every sign the screen promises, plus what each result means, so the post is useful on its own.

Golden Hour Studio: The best time of day for outdoor family photos

Buyer and job	Parents choosing a time for outdoor photos. Answer a planning question and show what her light looks like.
What to film	One 7-second clip from her own session: a family walking away from the camera in low evening sun.
Opening	Warm light already on the family. On screen: **"The best time of day for outdoor family photos"**
Caption	The best light for outdoor family photos is the hour before sunset. The sun is low and soft, so nobody squints, skin looks warm, and the background glows. How to plan it: - Look up the sunset time for your date. - Start your session about an hour before. - Feed the kids first. Hungry kids and golden light don't mix. In fall, sunset arrives earlier every week, so evening sessions move earlier too. When you book, I'll send the start time that matches your date.
Next step	Visit the booking page.
Why it works	Parents worry about timing more than photographers expect. The tip is accurate everywhere, and the clip shows the exact result being described.

Sunday Supply Co.: One tee, three ways (read the caption)

Buyer and job	People who want comfortable clothes that still look put together. Give outfit ideas people save, and show the tee in real life.
What to film	One 7-second shot: the owner folds the tee and slides it into the tote.
Opening	Hands already folding the tee. On screen: **"One tee, three ways (read the caption)"**
Caption	Annotated in Chapter 8: "a long caption that delivers," page 30.
Next step	Save the post, or tap the bundle link.
Why it works	Each outfit is specific enough to copy tomorrow morning. The bundle comes after the ideas, so the post is useful even to people who already own a favorite tee.

Paper & Pixel: Save this before you send invitations

Buyer and job	A parent about to send invitations. Give them a checklist they'll save.
What to film	One 8-second screen recording: typing a child's name into an invitation in Canva.
Opening	The cursor already in the name field. On screen: **"Save this before you send invitations"**

Caption	The party-invitation checklist: ☐ Start and end time (parents plan pickups around it) ☐ Full address, plus a map link for digital invites ☐ RSVP: who to tell, how, and by when ☐ Anything to bring: swimsuit, sneakers, a costume ☐ A line for allergies: "Let us know about any allergies" Send invitations two to three weeks before the party. Every Paper & Pixel kit has a spot for all five. $25, instant download, link in my bio.
Next step	Save the checklist; buy the kit.
Why it works	A checklist is a classic save, and every item names a real problem the kit solves.

Ops Clarity: 5 questions to ask before a project starts

Buyer and job	An agency owner about to start a new client project. Offer a tool they'll use at their next kickoff.
What to film	One 6-second shot: sticky notes being moved across a whiteboard.
Opening	A hand already moving a sticky note. On screen: **"5 questions to ask before a project starts"**
Caption	📋 Five questions to answer before any client project starts: 1. Who on the client side gives final approval? 2. How will feedback arrive? (One form beats four email threads.) 3. Who on our side owns each handoff? 4. When are our internal reviews? Put them on the calendar now. 5. What does "done" look like for this project? If a project goes sideways, one of these usually went unanswered. Save this for your next kickoff. If you'd like help building it into how your team works, my audit starts with a free 20-minute call. Link in bio.
Next step	Save it; book a call.
Why it works	The list is immediately usable, which shows expertise. Question 2 quietly connects to her best-known fix.

Edited clips with a voiceover

Fix-It Frank: How I fix a leaning fence post

Buyer and job	Homeowners with one or two loose posts. Show the repair, so the price feels worth it.
What to film	Six clips, 2 to 4 seconds each: the rotten post base; digging out the old concrete; the new post in the hole; pouring concrete; checking level; the finished, straight fence.
Opening	The rotten base, close up. On screen: **"How I fix a leaning fence post"**
Script	"This post rotted at the soil line, which is where most of them go. I dig out the old footing, set a new pressure-treated post, and pour fresh concrete. Then I check it's level on two sides before it sets. Same fence, standing straight, done in an afternoon."
Caption	One leaning post, fixed in an afternoon. Most posts rot right at the soil line, where water sits. Resetting one in fresh concrete usually costs far less than a new fence, as long as the boards are still solid. If yours is starting to lean, send me a photo through the quote form in my bio and I'll reply today.
Next step	Request a quote.
Why it works	Watching the work answers "what am I paying for?" without a single claim.

Golden Hour Studio: A 45-minute family session, start to finish

Buyer and job	Parents who've never had professional family photos. Show exactly what happens, so booking feels easy.
What to film	Eight clips: the family arriving; a quick tag game to warm up; a walking shot; a close-up of a hug; the photographer showing the kids the camera screen; the family leaving, relaxed. Film at your own session, with the family's permission to share.
Opening	The family stepping out of the car. On screen: **"A 45-minute family session, start to finish"**
Script	"Here's a whole session. We start with a game, so the kids forget the camera. Then we walk and talk, and I take the posed photo once everyone's relaxed. The kids get to see the camera. And forty-five minutes later, you're done, usually before anyone's tired."
Caption	Annotated in Chapter 8: "a caption that answers the unknowns," page 30.
Next step	Visit the booking page.

Why it works	First-time clients worry about the unknown. Seeing the whole session from arrival to goodbye answers most of their questions at once.

Sunday Supply Co.: Packing your order

Buyer and job	Shoppers deciding between Etsy sellers. Show care in every order.
What to film	Seven clips: folding a tee; wrapping it in tissue; placing it in the tote; adding a handwritten thank-you card; sealing the mailer; the label printing; the drop-off at the post office.
Opening	Hands smoothing a folded tee. On screen: **"Packing your order"**
Script	"Every order gets folded by hand, wrapped, and tucked into the tote, so it arrives ready to give or to use the same day. A note from me, sealed, labeled, and out the door within three days."
Caption	Packing a tee and tote bundle: folded by hand, wrapped, tucked into the tote, and on its way within three days. If you're buying it as a gift, add a note at checkout and I'll write it on the card. The bundle is $48, first link in my bio.
Next step	Buy the bundle.
Why it works	Packing videos show care and timing, two worries online buyers have. The gift note gives a practical reason to buy now.

Paper & Pixel: From blank kit to finished invitation

Buyer and job	A parent who needs invitations this week. Show how fast the kit is, and invite the purchase.
What to film	A screen recording in Canva, sped up into five clips: opening the kit; changing the name; changing the date and address; swapping the color; downloading. End on the finished invitation on a phone screen.
Opening	The blank kit opening in Canva. On screen: **"From blank kit to finished invitation"**
Script	"Open the kit. Type your child's name. Change the date, the time, and the address, and the map link updates with it. Pick your color. Download, and text it or print it. About ten minutes, start to finish."
Caption	Annotated in Chapter 8: "a short caption after a demo," page 31.
Next step	Buy the kit.
Why it works	The demo answers the main worry (is this hard?) by showing it. The caption can stay short because the video did the explaining.

Ops Clarity: What happens in an operations audit

Buyer and job	Agency owners curious about outside help. Explain what the audit includes, so a call feels low-risk.
What to film	Six clips: a laptop showing a project board; a whiteboard map of a project's steps; circling three spots on the map; a video call (screen only, no client faces); a one-page summary printing; the summary on a desk.
Opening	The project board scrolling. On screen: **"What happens in an operations audit"**
Script	"Here's what an audit looks like. I look at how one recent project moved through your team, step by step. We map it together, and I mark the places where work waited. Then you get a one-page summary with the three changes I'd make first, in order."
Caption	What you get from an Ops Clarity audit: - A map of how one real project moved through your team - The three places where work waited longest - A one-page plan with the changes to make first It's $500 and takes about two weeks. It starts with a free 20-minute call to see if it's a fit. Link in bio.
Next step	Book a call.
Why it works	Services feel risky when the buyer can't picture them. Naming the deliverable makes the price concrete.

Trending format, adapted

Fix-It Frank: 3 things I'd never do to my own fence

Buyer and job	Homeowners scrolling for quick tips. Reach new people with a familiar format.
What to film	Four 2-second clips: a post set without concrete; a sprinkler hitting the fence; a leaning section; Frank holding a level.
Opening	The first clip already on screen with text. On screen: **"3 things I'd never do to my own fence"**
Text and sound	On-screen text over each clip, with Frank's voice reading it: "Never skip the concrete. Never let the sprinkler hit the wood every day. Never wait until it's leaning."
Caption	Three things I'd never do to my own fence: 1. Set a post without concrete. 2. Let a sprinkler soak the same boards every day. 3. Wait until it's leaning to look at it. Already leaning? Send me a photo through the quote form in my bio.

Next step	Request a quote.
Why it works	The list format is recognizable, and Frank fills it with real advice. Using his own voice keeps the video free to post on every app.

Golden Hour Studio: You: My kids won't sit still. Me:

Buyer and job	Parents who assume their kids will ruin the photos. Reach new parents and ease a common worry.
What to film	Two clips from one session (with permission): a toddler running away from the camera, then the same family laughing together in the final photo.
Opening	The toddler mid-run. On screen: **"You: "My kids won't sit still." Me:"**
Text and sound	Text only, timed to the audio: "You: 'My kids won't sit still.'" over the first clip, then "Me: good." as the final photo appears.
Caption	Kids who won't sit still make some of my favorite photos. I plan for it: games first, posed photo later, and plenty of photos while they run. 45-minute sessions, $350. Booking page in my bio.
Next step	Visit the booking page.
Why it works	The "You: / Me:" format sets up a worry and answers it in two beats. The caption explains how she plans for it, which makes the answer believable.

Sunday Supply Co.: Getting ready for a Sunday with zero plans

Buyer and job	People who love slow weekends. Reach new people with a relatable mood.
What to film	Five 1-to-2-second clips: pulling the tee from a drawer; coffee pouring; feet up on the couch; walking to the farmers market with the tote; back on the couch.
Opening	The drawer sliding open. On screen: **"Getting ready for a Sunday with zero plans"**
Text and sound	No voiceover. On-screen text on the first and last clips. Use a song from Instagram's library that you have the rights to use for business, or the natural sound of the morning.
Caption	The whole plan: coffee 🧉, the market 🧺, the couch 🛋️. The tee is a heavier cotton that gets softer with every wash, and the tote holds a full market haul. Together they're $48, first link in my bio.
Next step	Tap the bundle link.
Why it works	Get-ready-with-me videos are a familiar format, and this one shows the product being worn all day without a sales pitch.

Paper & Pixel: Party invitation glow-up

Buyer and job	Parents planning a party soon. Reach new people with a satisfying before-and-after.
What to film	Two clips joined by a hand swipe across the lens: a plain, unreadable invitation on a phone, then the finished kit version.
Opening	The plain invitation on screen. On screen: **"Party invitation glow-up"**
Text and sound	Text on screen: "before" and "after." Swipe your hand across the lens to cut between them. Use your own sound or a library track that's cleared for business.
Caption	Same party, same details. The second one has a readable date, a map link, and an RSVP line that tells guests exactly what to do. That's every Paper & Pixel kit. $25, instant download, link in my bio.
Next step	Buy the kit.
Why it works	Glow-up videos get rewatched for the reveal. The caption names exactly what changed, so the improvement is clear.

Ops Clarity: Tell me you run an agency without telling me

Buyer and job	Agency owners and project managers. Reach new people with humor they recognize.
What to film	Three 2-second screen clips: a file named "final_v7_FINAL"; a chat full of "any update?" messages; a calendar with three meetings titled "quick sync."
Opening	The file name filling the screen. On screen: **"Tell me you run an agency without telling me"**
Text and sound	Text on screen only. No voiceover.
Caption	final_v7_FINAL, "any update?", and three quick syncs that weren't quick. If this is your week every week, the problem is usually where work changes hands. Reply "handoffs" and I'll send you the five questions I ask before any project starts.
Next step	Reply with a keyword.
Why it works	The joke lands only for the right buyer, which is the point. The reply offer is a simple, human next step, answered by hand.

Sources

Numbers in the text point to these sources. Each entry gives the date it was published or updated and, for studies, the data it covers. Platform features change often; if a menu has moved, search the app's settings for the feature's name.

1. **Socialinsider.** "2026 Instagram Organic Benchmarks." February 20, 2026. 35M posts from 447,613 brand profiles, January to December 2025. socialinsider.io/instagram-engagement-rate
2. **Metricool.** "How short-form video performs on social media: 2026 data and trends." August 26, 2026. 6,177,375 videos from 375,462 accounts on Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube. metricool.com/short-video-report-2026
3. **Instagram Help Center.** "About trial reels on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/1013292530224018
4. **Instagram Help Center.** "About professional accounts on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/138925576505882
5. **Instagram Help Center.** "Share Instagram reels to Facebook." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/459497729122868
6. **Instagram Help Center.** "Share your Instagram story to Facebook." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/1936968516554161
7. **Pinterest Help Center.** "Link your Instagram account." checked October 6, 2026. help.pinterest.com/en-gb/node/806
8. **Pinterest.** "What's new with Instagram account claiming on Pinterest." November 19, 2025. create.pinterest.com/en-gb/blog/instagram-account-claiming-updates
9. **Buffer.** "Pricing (Free plan)." checked October 6, 2026. buffer.com/pricing
10. **TechCrunch.** "Instagram tests new user control for recommended posts, transparency tool for creators (Instagram notifying creators when a Reel's reach may be limited by a watermark)." May 31, 2023. techcrunch.com/2023/05/31/instagram-tests-new-user-control-for-recommended-posts-transparency-tool-for-creators
11. **Buffer.** "State of Social Media Engagement 2026." March 5, 2026. Instagram format figures come from a separate Buffer analysis of 4M+ posts published through Buffer, January 2022 to October 2024. Engagement rate = (likes + comments + shares) ÷ reach. buffer.com/resources/state-of-social-media-engagement-2026
12. **Planoly.** "Instagram carousels are making a comeback (summarizing Adam Mosseri's explanation that a carousel can be shown again starting on slide 2, and noting that carousels with music may appear in the Reels tab)." April 28, 2025. planoly.com/blog/instagram-carousels-are-making-a-comeback
13. **Instagram Help Center.** "Add music to a post with multiple photos on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/1223433768344104
14. **Instagram Help Center.** "View insights on your Instagram reels." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/202865988324236

15. **Littledata.** "Ecommerce conversion rate benchmarks." updated October 2, 2026. 421 Shopify stores, June 29 to September 26, 2026. Conversion rate = share of sessions that included a purchase. littledata.io/average/ecommerce-conversion-rate-(all-devices)
16. **Shopify.** "Ecommerce conversion rate benchmarks (citing Dynamic Yield data from 400+ brands)." 2026; Dynamic Yield data as of June 2026. shopify.com/blog/ecommerce-conversion-rate
17. **Databox.** "Instagram benchmarks." updated October 5, 2026. Monthly medians from 1,400+ companies connected to Databox, from startups to enterprises. databox.com/instagram-benchmarks
18. **Buffer.** "Best Time to Post on Instagram in 2026." updated September 23, 2026. 9.6M Instagram posts from 200,000+ accounts, January 2024 to December 2025. Times are shown in each account's local time. "Best" = highest median engagement per follower. buffer.com/resources/when-is-the-best-time-to-post-on-instagram
19. **Social Samosa.** "Instagram reveals key factors for boosting reach (Adam Mosseri: watch time, likes per reach, and sends per reach matter most)." January 23, 2025. socialsamosa.com/news-2/instagram-reveals-key-factors-for-boosting-reach-8646916
20. **iPhone in Canada.** "Instagram rolls out ability to pin up to three comments (reporting Instagram's global rollout)." July 8, 2020. iphoneincanada.ca/news/ig-comment
21. **Instagram Help Center.** "Add text or captions to your video on Edits." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/9347605771917220
22. **Instagram Help Center.** "Use hashtags on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/351460621611097
23. **Instagram Help Center.** "Record a reel on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/2720958398006062
24. **Socialinsider.** "What Is the Ideal Instagram Reels Length?." July 14, 2026. 6M Reels from brand accounts, January to June 2026. Median views per Reel by length. socialinsider.io/blog/instagram-reels-length
25. **Social Media Today.** "Instagram adds retention insights for Reels (reporting Instagram's announcement of the retention chart and skip rate)." August 24, 2025. socialmediatoday.com/news/instagram-adds-retention-insights-reels/758464
26. **Instagram Help Center.** "Reel size & aspect ratios on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/1038071743007909
27. **Meta.** "Music Guidelines." checked October 6, 2026. facebook.com/legal/music_guidelines
28. **Music Business Worldwide.** "Instagram now lets users swap the music on published posts and carousels." July 2026. musicbusinessworldwide.com/instagram-now-lets-users-swap-the-music-on-published-posts-and-carousels
29. **Instagram Help Center.** "Image resolution of photos you share on Instagram." checked October 6, 2026. help.instagram.com/1631821640426723
30. **Business Today.** "Instagram rolls out link-sharing in Stories for all users (reporting Instagram's October 27, 2021 announcement)." October 28, 2021. businesstoday.in/amp/technology/launch/story/instagram-rolls-out-link-sharing-in-stories-for-all-users-launches-new-sticker-310662-2021-10-28

About the examples

Fix-It Frank, Golden Hour Studio, Sunday Supply Co., Paper & Pixel, and Ops Clarity are made up to show how the plan works. Their numbers, dates, and stories are illustrations, not results. Example photos are licensed stock (Unsplash License and Pexels License) standing in for each business's own photos.

Photo credits. Unsplash: Rory Tucker, Lance Grandahl, Justin Schwartfigure, Renee Mihld, Gabriel Alenius, Krzysztof Kowalik, Chris Barbalis, Sasikan Ulevik, Ian Talmacs, Mykyta Martynenko, Yucel M, Vitalii Khodzinskyi, Bailey Mahon, Alexander Mass, Jessica Rockowitz, Patty Brito, sammy swae, TuanAnh Blue, Mediamodifier, Brando Makes Branding, Good Faces, Hunter Newton, Vitaly Gariev, DISRUPTIVO, Zoe, Keagan Henman, Paulina Chmolowska, Kari Shea, Nathalia Segato, Silvia Mara, Seyedeh Hamideh Kazemi, Annie Spratt, Brooke Cagle, Kaleidico, Slidebean, Oguz Tombul, alan King, Juli Kosolapova, Benjamin Ho, Afffect, Laura Chouette. Pexels: Jonathan Cooper, Nothing Ahead, Riccardo Falconi, Los Muertos Crew, Daniel & Hannah Snipes, Luis Becerra.

Scrolly provides educational guidance, not legal advice, and does not grant or verify rights to music or other content.